**Episode 1**

1 INT. HOSPITAL, MARINA'S ROOM - DAY 1

ASHLEY WINTERS (18, innocent young woman, mature beyond her years, wearing a clean knee-length dress with long sleeves in light blue or pale yellow, fitted at the waist) watches DR. SAMUEL MITCHELL (28, male doctor, kind and upright) with deep concern as he removes his stethoscope.

ASHLEY
Doctor, how is my mother doing?

SAMUEL
(hesitating)
Actually... I would suggest it's better to let her go.

MARINA WINTERS (41, janitor, modest) lies in bed, looking haggard, eyes closed, connected to an IV.

SAMUEL (CONT'D)
Even if the surgery is successful, the follow-up treatment will cost a considerable amount. It's a bottomless pit, and in your situation, I'm afraid...

ASHLEY
(interrupting)
No. I won't give up, no matter what.

SAMUEL
(sighing)
Take some time to think it over. Also... if this month's medical bill isn't settled by the end of the day, we won't be able to continue treatment.

Samuel leaves, shaking his head helplessly. Ashley slides down the wall, sobbing. Marina slowly opens her eyes.

MARINA
(weakly)
Ashley.

Ashley wipes away her tears, approaches the bed with a forced smile.

ASHLEY
Mom, you're awake. Are you feeling bad anywhere?

Marina suddenly pulls out her IV needle, trying to get out of bed.

MARINA
Ashley, let's go home. No more treatment.

Blood seeps from Marina's hand. Ashley grabs her mother's arm, heartbroken.

ASHLEY
Mom, what are you doing?

Marina yanks her arm away.

MARINA
(firmly)
Enough... it’s been so many years. I've held you back for too long.

Marina tries to leave. Ashley blocks her path.

ASHLEY
Mom, what are you talking about? Don't worry about the money. I'll figure something out.

MARINA
(angry)
Like what? Take on more jobs? Your body can't handle it! You'll die before I do if you keep this up! You're young—you should be like other kids, going to college, pursuing your dreams.

ASHLEY
I can go to college anytime. Your health is what’s important right now.

MARINA
Are you trying to annoy me to death? You've already got your college offer, why won't you go? I don't want you trapped here because of me. You should be doing what you want with your life.

ASHLEY
(soothing)
Don’t be mad, Mom. I'll do as you say and go to college.

A text message alert sounds. Ashley reads "Come collect your paycheck" and her face lights up with hope.

ASHLEY (CONT’D)
Rest well, mom. I’m stepping out for a bit.

2 INT. HOSPITAL, HALLWAY - DAY 2

Ashley leaves the room, spots Samuel passing by, and grabs his arm.

ASHLEY
Doctor, please continue my mother's treatment. I'm getting paid today—I'll find a way to settle the bill, I promise.

Ashley gives Samuel a determined look, then runs off. Samuel shakes his head.

3 INT. ORION’S OFFICE - DAY 3

A luxury office in New York. ORION VALE (25, business tycoon, brilliant and wise) wearing a bespoke suit, stands with his back to the camera, reading a paper titled "Incorporating the AI Era’s Technical Innovation into Long-term Macroeconomic Analysis." He turns while expressing repeated admiration.

ORION
This article forecasts global economic development for the next decade. It aligns with my thinking perfectly. Find the author immediately.

JACK MERRITT (23, executive assistant, capable) stands by the desk with a tablet, pulling up Ashley's resume.

JACK (V.O.)
Sir, this paper came highly recommended from Harvard. The author is Ashley Winters, 18, a girl from the slums of Brownsville, Texas.

ORION
What? Only 18? She’s a genius, an absolute genius! Prepare the jet—I want to meet her right away. We cannot let talent like this slip away!

JACK
Yes, sir.

Orion and Jack hurry out.

**Episode 2**

4 INT. RESTAURANT, LOBBY - NIGHT 4

VINCENT HART (around 40, corrupt businessman, slightly overweight, Ashley’s uncle) lounges in the reception chair, * feet on the desk, cigar in mouth, tosses two envelopes onto the desk.

VINCENT
Here's your wages for the month. And your boyfriend, Noah’s.

Ashley stands at the counter, happily taking the envelopes.

ASHLEY
Thank you, Mr. Hart.

Ashley feels the envelopes, holding them up to compare thickness. One is noticeably thinner. She checks the amount written on her envelope: $2,500. Noah's reads: $5,000.

ASHLEY (CONT’D)
(confused)
Mr. Hart, Noah and I do the same job. Why is my salary only half of his?

Vincent takes a drag from his cigar, blowing a smoke ring, eyeing Ashley.

VINCENT
Don't be ungrateful, Ashley! I only kept you on as a favor to my niece.
(violently stubs out cigar)
The fact that I’m paying a girl this much is an act of charity.
(pointing at Ashley)
One should be content with what they have.

ASHLEY
But we agreed on five k. Why am I only getting half?

Vincent stands, approaches Ashley.

VINCENT
Why? Let me ask you—how many bathroom breaks do you take every day?

ASHLEY
I've been on my period.

VINCENT
Then why does each break last over ten minutes?

ASHLEY
Because there's always a line in the women's bathroom, but I've never let it affect my work.

VINCENT
Women employees are such a fucking hassle! I should've fired all you chicks, especially that pregnant one. Waddling into work around with that belly, can't do this, can't do that, "oooh, OSHA"— fucking annoying. *

ASHLEY
So just because we're women, we only deserve half a man's wage? We deserve to be fired if we get pregnant?

Vincent leans in close to Ashley.

VINCENT
Exactly. I can't afford to keep dead weight, I needa make money! If you can't work enough for your wage, then get the hell out!

Vincent glares menacingly at Ashley.

**Episode 3**

5 INT. RESTAURANT, LOBBY - NIGHT - CONTINUOUS 5

ASHLEY
But I handle more covers than all the male servers combined. I work one and a half times longer. I just want to get paid what I've earned.

VINCENT
Earned? Look at Noah—see how he charms the ladies, how many he brings in as customers every day.

Vincent points to Noah's photo on the wall labeled "Employee of the Month."

VINCENT (CONT'D)
Then look at you— name a single customer who'd come here for you!

ASHLEY
I'm a waitress, not a prostitute.

VINCENT
That's why you deserve less pay. If you wanna earn more, go work the streets—be a shame to waste that pretty face. * *

Vincent grabs Ashley's chin, examining her. She jerks away, furious.

ASHLEY
I just want to earn money with honest work. *

VINCENT
Don't you act all high and mighty. Your sick mother's in the hospital waiting for her bills to be paid, and you still wanna whine about your pay? Fine, then you won't get a single cent.

Vincent snatches the envelopes from Ashley's hands. She glares at him, eyes wide with anger.

ASHLEY
This is illegal. Aren't you afraid I'll report you?

VINCENT
Hmph, nobody in this area would dare touch Vincent Hart.
(MORE)

VINCENT (CONT'D)
But it's not like I can't give you the money. There is one way...

Vincent leers at Ashley's chest.

VINCENT (CONT'D)
Spend a night with me. I'll not only settle your wages, but add another two grand.

Vincent corners Ashley against the wall. She backs away, terrified.

ASHLEY
What do you think you're doing?

VINCENT
Stop putting on airs. Dressed like that, you're asking for it.

Vincent tries to tear at Ashley's clothes. She struggles.

ASHLEY
Help! Help!

Vincent slaps Ashley across the face.

VINCENT
Shut up, you whore. Everyone's gone home by now. No one to hear you scream.

Vincent continues trying to tear off Ashley's clothes as she desperately fights back.

ASHLEY
No! No! Help me!

VINCENT
Keep screaming. It turns me on more.

ASHLEY
No, no!

Ashley's dress is torn, her voice hoarse, face streaked with tears. The door suddenly opens—NOAH FLETCHER (18, handsome young man, cunning) appears in the doorway.

ASHLEY (CONT'D)
Noah.

Ashley's eyes fill with hope.

**Episode 4**

6 INT. RESTAURANT, LOBBY - NIGHT - CONTINUOUS 6

ASHLEY
Noah, help me!

NOAH
What's going on here?

Vincent startles, then slaps Ashley across the face.

VINCENT
So young and already so messed up! You dare to seduce me?! I'm your uncle!

Ashley freezes, holding her stinging cheek.

ASHLEY
But you were the one who—

Noah walks toward Ashley.

NOAH
(furious)
You won't even let me touch you, but here you are hooking up with Mr. Hart. What, only rich men are good enough for you? You're disgusting!

ASHLEY
No, that's not what happened.

Ashley reaches for Noah. He jerks away in revulsion.

NOAH
Don't touch me. You're filthy.

RUBY HART (18, expensively dressed, arrogant and domineering) pushes through the door, looking confused.

RUBY
Dad, Ashley, everyone's gone home. What're you still doing here?

NOAH
This shameless piece of trash was trying to seduce Mr. Hart while no one was around.

ASHLEY
(shaking her head desperately)
That's not true! He tried to rape me. Noah, you're my boyfriend—you have to believe me!

NOAH
You have the audacity to ask for my trust? I caught you red-handed throwing yourself at Mr. Hart!

Ruby storms forward and slaps Ashley hard across the face.

RUBY
You slut! You're my cousin, and you dare seduce my father!

ASHLEY
No, Ruby, let me explain—

Ruby slaps her again.

RUBY
Still trying to lie your way out of this? You think the Harts are so easy to fool?

Ashley falls to the ground. Ruby loops her arm through Noah's, both looking down at Ashley with contempt. Ashley stares at them in disbelief.

ASHLEY
You... you two?

NOAH
I wasn't planning to tell you so soon, but since you've revealed how much of a whore you are, I might as well spill it: Ruby and I are together. So stay away from me, you bitch!

ASHLEY
(eyes full of hurt)
You've been betraying me all along? Why?

Ruby leans down toward Ashley.

RUBY
You've got the nerve to ask why? How could my Noah possibly stay with someone like you—a worthless girl who'd sleep with anyone for money?

Ruby grabs Ashley's hair. Ashley struggles.

RUBY (CONT'D)
And now you dare seduce my father? I'll kill you!

Ruby raises her hand to strike, but BEATRICE WINTERS (around 75, commanding presence) and SELENA HART (around 40, refined socialite) appear in the doorway.

BEATRICE
Stop!

Ashley looks at Beatrice, eyes wide with terror.

**Episode 5**

7 INT. RESTAURANT, LOBBY - NIGHT - CONTINUOUS 7

Ashley breaks free from Ruby's grip and runs toward Beatrice, sobbing.

ASHLEY
Grandma, Uncle Vincent, he—

Ruby shoves Ashley aside and takes Beatrice's arm affectionately.

RUBY
Grandma Winters, Ashley waited for us all to leave, then tried to seduce my dad!

BEATRICE
What?

Selena steps forward furiously and slaps Ashley hard.

SELENA
You shameless whore! Seducing my husband?!

ASHLEY
(holding her cheek)
Aunty Selena, I didn't. Uncle Vincent tried to assault me!

Selena glares at Vincent, who lowers his head in feigned guilt.

VINCENT
Darling, don't listen to this little Jezebel. She came onto me—you know her mother needs money for medical bills. She just wanted a bigger paycheck.

ASHLEY
Aunty, that's not what happened at all!

Selena hesitates, then slaps Ashley again, harder.

SELENA
You vixen, always looking for a shortcut, huh? I'll teach you a lesson!

Ashley stands stunned.

BEATRICE
You’re so young, and already turning to extortion for that sick mother of yours. How dark your heart is!

NOAH
(spits)
Disgusting. Sleeping with anyone for money— to think I was ever with you, it makes me sick!

Ashley's eyes fill with hurt.

8 INT. LUXURY CAR - NIGHT 8

Orion sits in the back seat while Jack drives.

ORION
(checking his watch)
How much longer?

JACK
Ten minutes?

ORION
Speed up. It would be impolite to disturb Miss Winters too late at night. *

**Episode 6**

9 INT. RESTAURANT, LOBBY - NIGHT 9

ASHLEY
Why won't any of you believe anything I say? While he makes up nonsense and you buy it without question! What on earth did I do wrong?

NOAH
Your mistake was being born worthless and trying to climb above your station! Think about it—Mr. Hart owns this restaurant. How could he be interested in a blue-collar girl like you? Pathetic!

ASHLEY
So this is what you really think of me. I must have been blind to believe you'd stay with me forever.

NOAH
Forever? I was just a lonely teen back then, and you were a bit of a looker. Who would actually want to be with you?

Ashley stares in disbelief.

NOAH (CONT'D)
Who knew you'd be such a hypocrite—such a prude with your boyfriend, while going after your own uncle!

ASHLEY
I'll say it again: I did not seduce him!

NOAH
Whatever. Let me tell you something—Ruby and I are about to join Brownsville's biggest corporation, DM Company. We're destined for heights you can only dream of, while you'll be stuck caring for your sick mother, rotting in poverty forever.

ASHLEY
People like you— no conscience, no shame, no loyalty—no amount of money can hide how ugly you are.

RUBY
You've got a filthy mouth, time to wash it out!

Ruby walks to the side, picks up a bucket of dirty mop water, and dumps it over Ashley's head.

Ashley struggles desperately while Ruby and the others laugh.

SELENA
You little slut, seducing your uncle—I'll skin you alive!

Selena starts tearing at Ashley's clothes while Ashley fights back.

ASHLEY
No! No!

Ashley falls at Beatrice's feet. Beatrice kicks her away.

BEATRICE
Get lost! You've got the same despicable face as your vixen mother. Of all people to seduce, you chose your uncle!

ASHLEY
I didn't!

BEATRICE
Still denying it? I'll beat you to death!

Beatrice kicks Ashley again. Ashley stands shakily, her eyes defiant.

ASHLEY
I didn't do it, and even if you kill me today, I won't admit to something I didn't do.

SELENA
So stubborn. We'll have to teach you a lesson.

RUBY
Mom, let's ruin that pretty face of hers. That'll stop her from seducing anyone else.

SELENA
I can always count on you for good ideas.

Selena and Ruby grab Ashley's arms. Ruby grabs her hair and forces her face down onto the table.

ASHLEY
Let go of me! Let go!

RUBY
Noah, you do it.

Ruby throws a steak knife to Noah. He picks it up and moves to strike. *

Orion appears with Jack and two rows of BODYGUARDS (4 people), commanding the room.

ORION
STOP!

**Episode 7**

10 INT. RESTAURANT, LOBBY - NIGHT - CONTINUOUS 10

Orion gently drapes his suit jacket over Ashley. Her terrified eyes meet his. He helps her to her feet.

ORION
So many people ganging up on one girl—how very brave of you all!

SELENA
This is a family matter. Who are you to interfere?

VINCENT
Kid, you sure know how to talk big. What trash heap did you crawl out of?

ORION
(coldly)
I'm not going to waste words on scum like you.

Orion gently strokes Ashley's head.

ORION (CONT'D)
Don't be afraid. No one will dare hurt you again while I'm here.

ASHLEY
Sir, who are you? Why are you helping me?

ORION
Because you're worth it.

Orion lifts Ashley with one arm. Selena steps forward, blocking their path.

SELENA
Stop right there, boy. This little tramp is part of our family. You dare take her without my permission?

ORION
(sternly)
I suggest you get out of my way.

SELENA
What, you think you can lay a hand on me in my own territory?

Orion gives Jack a cold, fierce look.

ORION
Handle this.

JACK
Yes, Mr. President.

Jack signals, and the bodyguards form a line, blocking Selena and the others. Terror spreads across their faces.

**Episode 8**

11 INT. HOSPITAL, MARINA'S ROOM - DAY 11

Marina lies in her hospital bed. Jack stands at attention nearby.

JACK
Ma'am, please focus on your recovery. Your daughter has been taken in by our president. She'll be attending Harvard Business School.

Marina nods, relieved.

12 INT. SCHOOL, LIBRARY - DAY 12

Ashley, in collegiate clothes with a ponytail, searches through books, taking careful notes at her desk. *

13 INT. SCHOOL, AUDITORIUM - DAY 13

ANNOUNCER
Please welcome this year's distinguished graduate, winner of both the National Clark Economics Award and the Stevens Business Excellence Award, Ashley Winters. * *

Ashley, in graduation robes, receives her honors degree as the dean moves her tassel.

14 INT. CONFERENCE ROOM - DAY 14

SUPER: 10 YEARS LATER

ASHLEY
Our target for next quarter is 10 billion.

Ashley, in business attire, presents a PowerPoint. Two rows of EMPLOYEES applaud while Orion watches her admiringly.

15 INT. ANNUAL MEETING HALL - DAY 15

Ashley, in a tailored suit, rings the bell celebrating AO Group's IPO. Confetti rains down.

16 INT. ORION'S OFFICE - DAY 16

JACK
Sir, AO Group's net profit has exceeded one trillion dollars.

Orion stands at the floor-to-ceiling window, turning authoritatively.

ORION
She hasn't disappointed me. Is everything ready?

JACK
Sir, I've sent the share transfer agreement to your phone. The Blue Ocean Star necklace that Miss Winters has her eye on was secured at Sotheby's for twenty million.

Orion (now 35, the richest man in the world, commanding and handsome) takes the NECKLACE from Jack. Its diamonds sparkle.

ORION
Excellent.

JACK
Sir, are you planning to propose to Miss Winters?

Ashley (now 28, AO Group Chairwoman, elegant yet humble) enters confidently in a tailored suit dress, perfectly styled with makeup and accessories, she strides ably and dominantly from the doorway to Orion.

ASHLEY
Orion.

Orion signals Jack to leave. Jack gives Orion a playful thumbs-up before exiting. Ashley watches, puzzled.

ASHLEY (CONT'D)
Darling, our ten-year agreement is up. I've exceeded all targets—isn't it time to let me go home?

ORION
You're always so impatient. I've had Jack prepare the private jet.

Orion affectionately taps her nose.

ORION (CONT'D)
Look—I've unfrozen your funds, and transferred all my shares to your name.

He shows her his phone.

ORION (CONT'D)
Now the world's richest man works for you. Mind if I become your trophy husband, boss?

ASHLEY
Let's wait for your performance review.

Orion opens the necklace box.

ASHLEY (CONT'D)
Isn't this the Blue Ocean Star I've always wanted?

Orion fastens it around her neck.

ORION
Can I meet your mother now?

ASHLEY
Don't forget, we still have that contract with the Arabian prince.

ORION
(resigned)
I'll come find you as soon as I'm done.

Ashley nods.

ORION (CONT'D)
I heard your mother works at DM Company now. I've arranged to acquire it in your name— give her a little surprise.

ASHLEY
Thank you, darling.

**Episode 9**

17 EXT. MARINA'S HOUSE - NIGHT 17

Marina hurries home in her cleaning uniform, carrying supplies. She removes her arm covers as she walks, greeting two passing neighbors.

NEIGHBOR 1
Getting off work?

MARINA
Yes.

She nods and walks past.

NEIGHBOR 1
Poor Marina. Widowed so young, and that heartless daughter hasn't visited once in ten years.

NEIGHBOR 2
I heard she's working the streets.

NEIGHBOR 1
Really?

NEIGHBOR 2
Must be true. Her cousin Ruby saw her herself.

Marina stops and turns at their gossip.

MARINA
(to their backs)
Stop spreading lies! My daughter isn't like that!

The neighbors glance back before hurrying away.

18 I/E. MARINA'S HOUSE, DOORWAY - NIGHT 18

Marina reaches for her keys but finds the door ajar. She drops her bucket and rushes inside to find the place ransacked.

Selena and Vincent emerge, grinning, Selena clutching property papers. They collide with Marina.

MARINA
What are you doing in my home?!

SELENA
We're taking the deed, and we've sold most of what's inside. Take your things and get out.

Vincent throws a bag on the ground.

MARINA
What? You have no right to take my house! No right to sell my belongings!

Selena shoves Marina.

SELENA
Get lost! Your house? This is my mother's property. Now that my brother's gone, it's ours.

MARINA
Ben bought this house from Beatrice for Ashley. He paid for it!

SELENA
Look closely—whose name is on the deed? Beatrice Winters. My mother's name.

MARINA
We never completed the deed transfer, but the money was paid. Beatrice knows this!

SELENA
I'm not arguing with you. Only the name on the deed matters. Vincent, let's go!

They head out.

SELENA (CONT'D)
With the deed, we can claim compensation for demolishing this place.

MARINA
Stop right there! You can't take this house—Ashley won't have a home to return to!

SELENA
Return? Hah! Your daughter's a prostitute in NYC, she's probably in some man's bed right now. She's forgotten all about this dump!

MARINA
Impossible, absolutely impossible. Our Ashley would never do such things.

VINCENT
Ruby saw her while visiting New York. She was getting into some rich man's car. Ruby even took pictures—what more proof do you need?

MARINA
No. Ashley isn't like that.

SELENA
People change. Who knows what crowd she's running with now? Heard she's doing drugs too. She'll die on the streets sooner or later.

MARINA
(angry)
Don't you dare talk about my daughter like that!

SELENA
What? That trash can do whatever but we can't talk about it?

VINCENT
Why don't you join your whore daughter on the streets? Then you can have a family reunion. Then you two won't need this house, haha!

19 EXT. MARINA'S HOME - NIGHT 19

Selena and Vincent leave with the deed. Marina lunges for it.

MARINA
You've gone too far! Give it back!

SELENA
Get lost! Darling, take her keys.

Vincent snatches Marina's keys, passing them to Selena.

MARINA
What are you doing?

SELENA
What does it look like? Keeping you out of this house.

Selena locks the door, dangling the keys tauntingly.

SELENA (CONT'D)
Take them back if you can.

Marina rushes forward but Vincent restrains her.

MARINA
Give them back!

Vincent throws her to the ground.

MARINA (CONT'D)
You're nothing but thieves! This is my house—what right do you have to take it? What right to sell my things?

SELENA
Ignore her. Let's go.

Marina grabs Vincent's leg.

MARINA
No! You can't leave! Without this house, Ashley can't come home!

VINCENT
Filthy whore, get away from me!

Vincent kicks Marina repeatedly as she curls up on the ground. He spits on her before leaving with Selena. Rain begins to fall as Marina lies there in pain.

MARINA
Ashley, where are you? Please come home.

**Episode 10**

20 EXT. CITY - NIGHT 20

A time-lapse of the city skyline, transitioning from night to day.

21 EXT. MARINA'S HOUSE - DAY 21

Marina leans against the wall, disheveled and exhausted. Her phone chimes, startling her awake. She checks the message.

ASHLEY (V.O.)
Mom, I'm coming home today!

Marina sits up straight, shocked and excited. Her eyes widen as she reads the message with trembling hands.

22 EXT. PRIVATE JET - DAY 22

Ashley stands at the boarding gate, wearing an elegant silk scarf around her neck.

ASHLEY (V.O.)
And I'm bringing my fiancé.

23 EXT. PRIVATE JET - DAY (STOCK FOOTAGE) 23

Establishing shot of the plane flying through the sky.

ASHLEY (V.O.)
Wait for me at home, okay?

24 EXT. MARINA'S HOUSE - DAY 24

MARINA
(tears in her eyes)
It's Ashley... Ashley... my Ashley is coming back, and she's bringing her fiancé.

Marina frantically tries to smooth her hair with her hands.

MARINA (V.O.)
No, I must get the house back. I can't let Ashley come home to nothing.

Marina heads out while speaking.

25 INT. PRIVATE JET - DAY 25

Ashley reclines in a spacious seat, gazing thoughtfully out at the blue sky. ZOE ELLSWORTH (26, secretary, sharp and efficient) sits nearby giving her report. Ashley turns her attention away from the window.

ZOE
Chairwoman, I got a message from Manager David at DM Company. He asked if we could celebrate their company's top sales performer at the upcoming signing ceremony. He hopes you'll do them the honor of presenting the award personally.

ASHLEY
Fine, I'll give him that.

26 INT. PROMOTIONAL CEREMONY HOTEL, LOBBY - DAY 26

The venue is elegantly decorated with an LED screen displaying "OA & DM Group Investment Ceremony." Guests mingle in small groups, drinking and socializing. A poster of Noah in his executive best stands at the entrance, labeled "Noah Fletcher - DM Annual Sales Champion."

Noah and Ruby chat with guests, wine glasses in hand.

GUEST A
Mr. Fletcher, having the signing ceremony and your promotion ceremony on the same day - it really shows how much they value you.

GUEST B
I heard your promotion came directly from the AO Group’s Chairwoman herself - and she'll be presenting your award personally.

NOAH
(modestly)
You're too kind.

GUEST B
I wouldn't be surprised if you became DM's next general manager.

GUEST A
When the time comes, Mr. Fletcher, we hope you'll remember us.

NOAH
Actually, another VIP guest will be joining us today.

GUEST B
Could it be true? The world's richest man is coming?

NOAH
That's right.

GUEST A
This Mr. Vale is even more intimidating than the AO Group’s Chairwoman.

GUEST B
They say he started from nothing at 19, then took the world by storm with his global empire. In just four years, he became the youngest billionaire in history at 21!

GUEST A
But this global tycoon is known for his incredibly high standards.
(MORE)

GUEST A (CONT'D)
He rarely attends any ceremonies - the fact that he's coming today, Mr. Fletcher, speaks volumes about your future.

Noah toasts with the guests as Selena and Vincent enter the hall.

SELENA
Wow, so this is how a major corporation throws parties - such grandeur.

RUBY
Of course! This is a signing ceremony by the world's largest financial conglomerate, AO Group. Absolutely luxurious.

VINCENT
Noah's really made it.

SELENA
Ruby, you better lock him down.

27 INT. PROMOTIONAL CEREMONY HOTEL, LOBBY ENTRANCE - DAY 27

Marina spots Noah's poster at the entrance.

MARINA
This must be it. They must be inside.

Marina walks into the hotel.

**Episode 11**

28 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY 28

Marina enters, looking around. Selena takes a pleasurable sip of wine, spots Marina in her peripheral vision, and sets down her glass with disgust.

SELENA
Why is she here?

Selena storms over to Marina, blocking her path with arms crossed.

SELENA (CONT'D)
Stop right there!

MARINA
Selena, I was looking for you all.

SELENA
Looking for us? Here? Do you have any idea what kind of event this is? Does this look like somewhere you belong?

VINCENT
This is Noah's promotion ceremony. Everyone here is somebody important. A poor cleaning lady like you needs to leave. Now.

MARINA
Selena, give the deed to my house back, and I'll go.

SELENA
What house? I don't have anything of yours.

MARINA
Ashley is coming back soon. I won't leave until you return it - she'll have nowhere to live.

Selena leans in close to Marina's ear with a menacing whisper.

SELENA
These are all VIP guests, and more important people are coming. If you keep making a scene, don't blame me for what happens next.

MARINA
I don't care what bigshots are coming. You have to return the house today.

SELENA
You're really asking for it!

Selena violently slaps Marina, who staggers but maintains her fierce glare.

SELENA (CONT'D)
Vincent, the AO Group's Chairwoman and the richest man in the world will be here any minute. Get her out of here before she embarrasses everyone.

Vincent grabs Marina's hair and starts dragging her away. Marina struggles.

MARINA
Let go of me! I'm not leaving! Ashley is coming back soon - I can't let her be locked out of her own home!

SELENA
Vincent, release her.

Vincent throws Marina to the ground, wiping his hands in disgust.

SELENA (CONT'D)
I'm telling you, stop dreaming. Even when you're in your grave, Ashley won't be coming back!

MARINA
You're lying! Ashley just messaged me, she said she's almost here.

SELENA
Marina, you're something else - you'd lie through your teeth for that shitty little shack!

MARINA
I'm not lying. It's all true.

VINCENT
Looks like you won't leave until we teach you a lesson!

MARINA
What, you steal my house and now you want to beat me up? You think you're above the law?

Vincent kicks Marina to the ground.

VINCENT
I <u>am</u> above the law! What're you going to do about it? You goddamn waste, you've lived long enough, and still don't know who runs things around here?

Vincent unleashes a series of brutal kicks at Marina, who clutches her stomach, blood trickling from her mouth.

Guests nearby film the incident on their phones.

**Episode 12**

29 INT. PRIVATE JET - DAY 29

ZOE
Chairwoman, your mother is at the signing ceremony. Someone uploaded this video of her to Facebook - I think you should see it.

Zoe hands Ashley a tablet. Watching the video of Marina being humiliated, Ashley clenches her fists so tight her nails dig into her palms.

ASHLEY
Mom...

Ashley's eyes well up with tears of pain and anger.

ASHLEY (CONT'D)
Those degenerates! How long until we arrive?

ZOE
Still thirty minutes, chairwoman.

ASHLEY
I don't care what it takes - get us there in fifteen.

ZOE
Yes, ma'am.

30 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY 30

SELENA
I'll tell you the truth - I already sold everything from the house yesterday. These jewels and accessories today? I bought it with that money. Haha!

MARINA
What? How could you be so cruel!

VINCENT
Today's fine wine is all thanks to your house playing its part.

MARINA
Those were my things! You're too much, how can you be so heartless?

SELENA
My mother gave that house to my brother. Now that he's gone, it belongs to us.

MARINA
That house was Ben's gift to Ashley.

SELENA
(arrogantly)
Oh really? Then where is she? Go ahead, show me where she is! Ha!

MARINA
She said she's coming back soon.

SELENA
Stop pretending. Let's be honest - you just want money, don't you?

MARINA
I don't want your money. I just want my house back.

VINCENT
Stop acting so noble! You're sleeping on the streets yet still trying to hold onto your pathetic dignity.

SELENA
You know what, I'm not unreasonable. Here, Marina.

Selena pulls out a stack of cash from her purse.

SELENA (CONT'D)
You want your house? Here it is!

Selena laughs maniacally while throwing money into the air. Bills rain down, landing on Marina's face and body. Vincent and Selena laugh together hysterically.

31 EXT. LAWN - DAY 31

A private jet lands on the grass. Two rows of bodyguards stand at attention on either side as Ashley descends from the plane, her face stern and commanding.

**Episode 13**

32 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY 32

MARINA
(glaring)
You steal my house, humiliate me like this - do you have any conscience left?

Marina lunges forward. Selena violently slaps her.

SELENA
Worthless beggar! You dare give me attitude!

Marina crashes into a nearby table, sending a row of wine bottles crashing down. Noah and Ruby rush over at the commotion. Noah storms up and viciously slaps Marina across the face.

NOAH
You old hag, how dare you come here and ruin my ceremony!

RUBY
Do you have any idea how much that wine costs? At least a hundred thousand!

NOAH
Old wretch, you couldn't earn that much cleaning a lifetime’s worth of toilets, but you're paying for every cent of it!

MARINA
You splurge with my money, then demand I pay you back? Are you even human? If I can't get the house back, even if I die here, I’m not leaving.

SELENA
You want the house that badly? Since we’re family, fine. I'll give you one more chance.

Selena pulls out the property deed from her purse.

SELENA (CONT’D)
I want you to crawl to me... over <u>this</u>.

Selena points to the shattered glass on the floor. Marina hesitates.

MARINA
You’re really pushing it-!

NOAH
What's wrong? You don’t understand Mrs. Hart?

VINCENT
Gone deaf? Crawl!

RUBY
Crawl, you old hag!

Selena stands at the other end of the glass, holding the deed, looking down at Marina with contempt. Nearby guests laugh and mock her.

GUESTS
(taunting)
Crawl! Crawl!

MARINA
That house was mine! Give it back!

Marina rushes forward to grab the deed, but Selena deftly moves away.

SELENA
You're really pushing your luck.

Vincent seizes the moment to kick the back of Marina's knees, forcing her to fall onto the glass shards. Marina screams in pain.

33 EXT. HOTEL - DAY 33

Three luxury cars screech to a precise stop outside the entrance. Six black-suited BODYGUARDS exit and take position. One opens the door of the first car. An elegantly heeled foot steps out as Zoe rushes to hold an umbrella. Ashley emerges, stern-faced, wearing an exquisite designer suit dress, silk scarf, and refined earrings - the very picture of authority.

34 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY 34

The crowd jostles Marina, whose knees are bleeding from the glass.

CROWD
Crawl! Hurry up and crawl!

Ashley strides in with Zoe, radiating fury.

ASHLEY (O.S.)
STOP!

Selena, Vincent, Noah, Ruby, and the crowd freeze in shock.

**Episode 14**

35 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY 35

ASHLEY
Mom.

MARINA
Ashley? Ashley, is it really you?

Marina struggles to stand from the glass. Ashley rushes to support her.

ASHLEY
Mom, it's me. I'm Ashley. I'm back.

Marina studies Ashley's face intently before tears start flowing.

MARINA
Ashley... my Ashley.

ASHLEY
Mom, your knees...

Ashley sees the glass shards and fury flashes across her face.

MARINA
Mommy’s fine. Now that you're back, everything’s fine.

ASHLEY
Mom, wait here. Today, they'll pay for this in blood.

NOAH
You’ve got some nerve coming back, you prostitute. What, still can't get over me after all these years? Chasing me all the way to my promotion ceremony?

Ashley notices Noah's sales champion poster nearby.

ASHLEY (V.O.)
What irony - so the DM employee requesting a promotion and raise is this scum. Perfect timing to settle both old and new scores.

ASHLEY
(with a cold smile)
It’s been ten years, and you're still just as much of a narcissist. You’re such garbage, only someone like Ruby would fancy you.

RUBY
Well, well, look who's got a sharp tongue. Bitch, you think wearing nice clothes gives you the right to talk big here?

Ruby circles Ashley, examining her closely. Ashley meets her gaze with icy contempt.

RUBY (CONT’D)
Tsk tsk, this year's Chanel haute couture...

SELENA
(mockingly)
Ashley, look how well you've done for yourself these ten years! Maybe I ought to give some respect? Ha!

VINCENT
A whole wardrobe of designer knockoffs - how befitting of a prostitute. I guess you’re a "high-class escort,” then?

ASHLEY
A prostitute?

RUBY
Ha! My dear cousin, you think we're so easily fooled?

MARINA
Ashley, why don’t you tell everyone what you've really been doing all these years. Ruby says she saw you getting into a rich man's car.

ASHLEY
Mom, what are you talking about? I've been working in finance in New York. Every penny I've earned is through my own effort.

RUBY
Liar! When I was in New York, I saw you getting into a limo with some rich man. If that wasn't prostitution, what was it?
(Ruby holds up her phone)
Look - you dare say this isn't you?

Ruby shows Ashley a photo of her about to enter a luxury car outside an upscale hotel. Orion sits in the driver's seat, smartly dressed in a suit, smiling warmly at Ashley. Ashley looks at the photo and smiles.

ASHLEY (V.O.)
Isn't this from my date with Orion?

ASHLEY
Yes, that's me. But it's not what you think - because the man in the photo is my fiancé.

36 INT. LUXURY CONFERENCE ROOM - DAY 36

Orion exchanges contracts with an ARAB PRINCE, then they pose for photos shaking hands.

ORION
A pleasure doing business.

Orion checks his watch and strides forward, Jack following.

ORION (CONT'D)
(to Jack)
Cancel the rest of my overseas meetings, and arrange the private jet. I need to join Ashley immediately.

JACK
Yes, sir.

Orion hurriedly departs with his entourage of bodyguards.

**Episode 15**

37 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY 37

NOAH
Fiancé? That's hilarious. Anyone with eyes can see he's just another john paying for your services.

RUBY
Don't tell me you call every client your fiancé. I feel sick thinking about it!

ASHLEY
Only someone with a mind as filthy as your mouth could come up with that.

NOAH
What's wrong? You're mad because I saw right through you?

SELENA
I'm sure you just heard, Noah's caught the attention of AO Group's chairwoman and the world's richest man. Of course you came running. What, hoping to ride his coattails?

VINCENT
Such a cheap, desperate whore.

ASHLEY
(with cold derision)
Why would I need to ride the coattails of scum like Noah?

SELENA
Shut your dirty mouth! Noah's a rising star making millions. You're just a rat from the gutter - if this isn't you throwing yourself at him, then what do you call it?

RUBY
Our Noah is just too exceptional. That's why you're still desperately clinging to him, fantasizing about rekindling what you had.

NOAH
Let me make this clear - quit dreaming. Even if you stripped naked in front of me right now, I wouldn't give you a second glance.

ASHLEY
(with icy amusement)
You two truly deserve each other. Rest assured, trash belongs with trash. I wish you all the happiness in the world.

NOAH
You worthless slut. You can only manage cheap shots now, huh? Leaving you for Ruby was the best decision of my life. If I stayed with you, I'd be even poorer, but Ruby's opened so many doors for me. Without her, I'd have nothing I have today.

ASHLEY
Ruby's opened doors for you?

NOAH
Of course! My promotion, catching the eye of AO Group's chairwoman, having the world's richest man attend my ceremony - it's all thanks to Ruby.

ASHLEY
I think I understand now... but do you really believe Ruby is responsible for your promotion?

NOAH
(sneering)
If not Ruby, then who? You?

ASHLEY
That's right, it is me. Though if I'd known it was you being promoted, I never would have approved it.

NOAH
Have you lost your mind, Ashley? Listen to yourself! Since when does my promotion need your approval? I suggest you leave while you can. When the AO Group chairwoman and the richest man arrive, you won't be a fan of what happens!

ASHLEY
The AO Group chairwoman? You mean me?

Ashley regards Noah with cool composure.

38 INT. DAVID'S OFFICE - DAY 38

Nameplate: David Porter, DM Company General Manager

DAVID
Is everything prepared for Noah?

RYAN
Yes, sir. The million-dollar trophy of solid gold, BMW sports car, and share agreement are all ready.

DAVID
Good. Have them delivered to the ceremony immediately.

RYAN BENNETT (27, male assistant, sharp) hesitates, looking troubled.

DAVID (CONT'D)
What is it?

RYAN
Sir, we just discovered Noah Fletcher forged his academic transcripts. Promoting him now... isn't it a bit appropriate?

David pauses, wheels turning in his mind.

DAVID
Shut up! What do you know? He's the chairwoman's ex-boyfriend - they only broke up ten years ago because she had to go to New York. Think about it - how else would a company like DM catch the chairwoman's attention?

RYAN
So you mean...?

DAVID
Soon everyone at DM will probably be calling Noah 'boss.' We need to play this right - keep Noah happy, and we keep the chairwoman happy.

David smirks knowingly at Ryan.

39 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY 39

Noah shakes his head with contemptuous laughter.

NOAH
You've lost it. You're actually insane, pretending to be the AO Group chairwoman. Do you even know who she is? In the business world, she's practically a god.

RUBY
Exactly. She built everything from nothing, turning a startup of a few dozen people into the world's largest conglomerate in just five years.

SELENA
And you? You're not even worthy to kiss her feet. * *

ASHLEY
Actually, I'd say she and I are quite similar.

VINCENT
How dare you! Show some respect for the AO Group chairwoman. If you want to die, fine, but don't drag us down with you.

Ashley gives a cold smile.

NOAH
You worthless woman, say one more word and I'll rip your mouth open!

SELENA
The chairwoman is like the sun in the sky - how dare gutter trash like you sully her name! You'll pay for this when she arrives.

MARINA
Ashley, what do we do? We should leave now, hurry.

ASHLEY
Don't worry, Mom. I'm utterly capable of protecting myself now. Just watch - everyone who humiliated you will pay for what they've done.

VINCENT
That's rich - make us pay? I'll make you pay for that big mouth of yours right now!

Vincent advances menacingly toward Ashley, raising his hand to strike. Marina jumps in front of Ashley.

MARINA
No one touches my daughter!

VINCENT
Get out of my way, you old hag!

Vincent shoves Marina to the ground. Ashley rushes to help her.

ASHLEY
Mom!
(furiously)
Guards!

Six bodyguards rush in from the entrance, brandishing batons, radiating authority.

ASHLEY (CONT'D)
Everyone who dared abuse my mother today will face the consequences they deserve.

Vincent, Selena, Noah, and Ruby stand frozen in shock.

**Episode 17**

40 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 40

NOAH
Wow, Ashley, you brought bodyguards with you? You must be someone important.

RUBY
You really went all out for this act. Just don't come crying to us when you can't pay your bodyguards' salaries, ha!

ASHLEY
Act?

SELENA
If it’s not an act, then what is it? A joke? A poor girl like you, I thought you’d try something clever.

VINCENT
Poor people always pretend to be something they’re not, trying to save face and suffering for it. You deserve to rot in the gutter! You should consider it a blessing to even humiliated by us, and here you are, still putting on airs.

ASHLEY
You’ll find out soon enough whether it’s an act or not. If you don’t believe me, maybe you’ll believe the richest man in the world.

SELENA
How dare you? The richest person in the world? If he sees a whore like you at this banquet, he’ll think this place has hit rock bottom. If you know what’s good for you, take your mother and get out!

ASHLEY
And what if I don’t?

NOAH
The chairman is arriving soon. If you keep this up, you’ll be sorry.

SELENA
Don’t waste your breath, Vincent. Just throw them out.

RUBY
Yeah, Dad, teach this bitch a lesson.

VINCENT
(to Ashley)
You’ve really gone too far today. I’ll show you the true meaning of despair.

Vincent grabs a wine bottle and strides toward Ashley.

ASHLEY
(firmly)
Fine. Then today we'll settle the score.

**Episode 18**

41 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 41

Vincent moves to strike Ashley, but is intercepted by a bodyguard, who smashes a baton across his head. Blood streams down his face.

ASHLEY
Vincent, I'm no longer the little shop assistant that you could push around. You won't be able to even lay a finger on me.

RUBY
How dare you hurt my dad! I'll kill you!

Ruby lunges at Ashley but is shoved to the ground by a bodyguard. Noah rushes to help Ruby up.

NOAH
You bitch! This banquet is for MY promotion. If you think you can cause trouble here, you've got another thing coming.

SELENA
You've really crossed the line. I'll teach you a lesson!

Noah and Selena step forward, ready to attack Ashley.

ASHLEY
Get them!

A row of bodyguards steps forward, striking Noah and Selena with batons.

RUBY
Are you insane? Call off these actors already!

VINCENT
If Selena gets so much as a scratch, I'll kill you!

NOAH
You think you can cause trouble here? When the chairman of AO Group and the richest man get here, you'll regret this.

ASHLEY
When he arrives, he'll stand by me. You're the ones who will suffer.

SELENA
Nonsense! Marina, make her stop! If this gets out of hand, neither of you will get out of this unscathed.

Marina quickly steps in to stop Ashley.

MARINA
Ashley, that's enough. Please, stop.

ASHLEY
No, it's not enough! Mom, have you forgotten how they humiliated you? Don't they deserve to be taught a lesson? Don't you want to see them pay?

SELENA
You ungrateful wretch! I'm your aunt!

ASHLEY
Oh, now you remember you're my aunt? How come you forgot that when you were humiliating my mom?

SELENA
She's just a cleaning lady. She doesn't belong in a high-class place like this.

VINCENT
Exactly. She needs to understand the gap between people like us and people like her.

ASHLEY
You think just because she's working-class, she deserves to be humiliated?

SELENA
Yes! Her biggest mistake was being born into the lower-class!

ASHLEY
Everyone is equal at birth. Today I'll show you that. The mistake isn't being born at the bottom—it's your arrogance and contempt! Guards!

The bodyguards line up.

ASHLEY (CONT'D)
Pin them down on the broken glass. Make them pay a hundred times for what they did!

Ashley holds up a tablet, showing the bodyguards videos of Selena slapping Marina, Vincent kicking her, and Noah striking her.

**Episode 19**

42 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 42

Noah is grabbed by a bodyguard as he struggles fiercely.

NOAH
Let me go! I was personally promoted by the chairman of AO Group. You mess with me, you mess with the chairman!

SELENA
She'll be here soon. When she arrives, you'll regret this!

ASHLEY
Oh? I'm afraid you'll be disappointed. Keep going!

Two bodyguards grab Noah, Selena, Vincent, and Ruby. The four struggle relentlessly.

SELENA
Let go! Let me go!

NOAH
Release me!

RUBY
How dare you!?

ASHLEY
Oh, I dare. Hold them down and beat them!

Noah, Selena, Vincent, and Ruby are forcibly pressed onto the shards of glass. The bodyguards slap them repeatedly as the four continue to struggle.

VINCENT
I'm warning you, don't take this too far.

ASHLEY
You cowards. Still trying to threaten me? Keep hitting them!

BEATRICE (O.S.)
Ashley! And who gave you permission to do this?

Beatrice, supported by a maid, makes a commanding entrance.

**Episode 20**

43 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 43

Ashley raises her hand, signaling the bodyguards to stop. Ruby, Noah, Selena, and Vincent seize the opportunity to break free.

Beatrice steps forward and slaps Ashley hard across the face.

ASHLEY
(holding her cheek)
Grandma, you hit me without even asking what happened?

BEATRICE
You've gone too far, you ungrateful wretch! The moment you get home, you immediately start attacking your own family? Do you really think you can do whatever you want?

RUBY
Thank goodness you're here, Grandma! Ashley has become a prostitute. She came back just to ruin Noah's banquet. You have to help us!

SELENA
Mom, the world's richest man and the chairman of AO Group haven't arrived yet. And even Mr. Porter is late. Who knows if this little bitch is behind all of this?

BEATRICE
(angrily)
You wretch! You won't rest until you've destroyed our family, is that it?

ASHLEY
(to Zoe)
Why hasn't David arrived yet? Go find out what's going on.

ZOE
Yes, ma'am.

Zoe steps outside to make a call.

44 INT. DAVID'S OFFICE - DAY 44

Zoe's call comes through. David stands up and answers the phone respectfully.

DAVID
Secretary Ellsworth here. What? The chairman is already there?

ZOE (V.O.)
You have ten minutes. If you're not here, I think we can cancel today's signing banquet.

DAVID
Understood. I'm on my way. Let's go.

David and Ryan hurry out of the office.

**Episode 21**

45 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY 45

ASHLEY
Grandma, you've always only believed only what you wanted to believe.
(MORE)

ASHLEY (CONT'D)
It's just like it was 10 years ago. Have you ever actually thought of me as a granddaughter?

BEATRICE
A worthless thing like you, who only brings shame and disgrace to the family? No! I'd rather have nothing to do with you at all.

ASHLEY
So that's it. You want to cut ties with me?

BEATRICE
That's right. Ruby is the only granddaughter I need. She's found a boyfriend like Noah, who earns millions of dollars per year. She's far more accomplished than you'll ever be.

Ashley shakes her head with a cold smile.

ASHLEY
By my calculations, David should be here soon. Then you'll see who the truly accomplished one is.

SELENA
How dare you! A gutter rat like you doesn't even deserve to be here, and you dare to call Mr. Porter by his first name? Let's see how long you can keep up the act. Where is Mr. Porter? Where is he?

46 INT. DAVID'S CAR - DAY 46

DRIVER
Sir, there seems to be an accident up ahead.

David anxiously checks his watch from the back seat.

DAVID
Then take a side road. I don't care how you do it, but you must get me there in five minutes.

DRIVER
Yes, sir.

47 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY 47

RUBY
You little bitch! If Mr. Porter finds out you've been impersonating the chairman, you're finished. And you'll drag our entire family down with you.

ASHLEY
Don't worry about that. When David arrives, he'll only treat me with the utmost respect.

**Episode 22**

48 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 48

BEATRICE
You're utterly shameless! You're a blight upon the Winters family If I had a choice, I'd rather not associate with you at all.

ASHLEY
After all these years, Grandma, you're still the same. You never bother to find out what's going on. Since that's the case, there's nothing left for me here. Prepare the agreement!

Ashley's eyes are resolute.

ZOE
Yes, ma'am.

ASHLEY
I hope you won't regret this when David arrives.

BEATRICE
Regret? Do you think Mr. Porter's arrival will somehow change the fact that you're trash? If I don't take the opportunity to cut ties with you today, we'll regret it when Mr. Porter gets here and holds us all accountable.

SELENA
Hurry up and sign the agreement. Mr. Porter will be here soon.
(MORE)

SELENA (CONT'D)
This is disgraceful. Then once it's done, take your sick mother and get out of here.

BEATRICE
The thought that you carry the Winters family blood makes me sick. I'd love to cut all ties with someone as dirt-poor as you.

ASHLEY
Fine. I don't want to claim this bloodline anyways.

Zoe hands over the severance agreement folder. Ashley signs it and shoves the contract onto Beatrice.

ASHLEY (CONT'D)
(steadfast)
From this moment on, I owe nothing to the Winters family. That means your fates no longer concern me.

49 EXT. HOTEL ENTRANCE - DAY 49

David's luxury car screeches to a halt outside the hotel. Ryan opens the car door for David, who steps out with authority, glancing at his watch.

DAVID
Good, there's still one minute left. I'm not too late.

David, followed by Ryan and a group of four bodyguards, rushes inside.

50 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY 50

BEATRICE
You wretched girl! From now on, don't you dare take a single penny from the Winters family. And you, all these irrelevant people, get out of here now!

DAVID
Who's causing trouble here?

Everyone turns to the entrance as David, Ryan, and a group of bodyguards (4) make a commanding appearance.

51 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 51

David enters commandingly. Noah quickly steps forward to greet him.

NOAH
(beaming)
Mr. Porter, you're finally here! A couple of pests have barged in, but it's all been taken care of.

DAVID
How efficient. Well done. Everyone should learn from Noah.

Selena and Ruby exchange delighted looks.

BEATRICE
(to Selena, whispering)
Hurry up and find a way to get rid of them. What will Mr. Porter think if he sees this mess?

DAVID
Bring it in.

Ashley turns her back to the scene.

Three ceremonial hostesses enter, carrying trays. The center tray holds a gleaming pure gold trophy, flanked by a BMW car key and an exquisite contract.

NOAH
(surprised and delighted)
Manager, what's this?

RYAN
A sales champion trophy in pure gold, worth 1 million. And the key to a BMW, worth 2 million. This is to reward your work as the top salesperson and to thank you for your contributions to the company.

NOAH
(falsely modest)
Manager, this is too much.

Noah greedily touches the trophy and car key.

BEATRICE
You're so generous, Mr. Porter.

DAVID
It’s the right thing to do, Mrs. Winters. Your family truly produces exceptional talent.

BEATRICE
Thank you for taking Noah under your wing.

DAVID
It’s my honor. The DM Corporation will continue to rely on your family in the future.

BEATRICE
Rely on us?

Beatrice glances around, confused.

BEATRICE (CONT’D)
Oh, you flatter us.

RUBY
Mr. Porter, Noah will still need your guidance.

DAVID
You’re too kind. Noah, the company has decided to grant you an annual salary of one million dollars and 10% of the company’s shares. Here’s the contract.

David hands over the contract. Noah takes it, visibly excited.

NOAH
(emotional)
10% of the shares? Mr. Porter, are you serious?

DAVID
Absolutely.

SELENA
10% of the shares must be worth millions, right?

NOAH
Probably tens of millions.

GUEST A
Since the news broke that DM Company is about to be acquired by the global conglomerate AO Group, the stock price has skyrocketed. It’s almost impossible to get any shares now.

GUEST B
10% of the shares is an immeasurable value. It could be worth billions in the future.

GUEST A
This is like creating a new dynasty of wealth, isn’t it?

SELENA
Billions of dollars?

**Episode 24**

52 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 52

NOAH
That's right. Billions!

SELENA
Oh my! It sounds like our family is on the up and up.

BEATRICE
(beaming with joy)
The Winters family is going to make it big! Lady Luck is on our side. Thank you, Mr. Porter.

DAVID
Madam, you shouldn't thank me. You should thank your own family for producing such an extraordinary individual.

BEATRICE
Extraordinary individual? Who do you mean?

DAVID
Isn't it obvious? Your own granddaughter. She's not just the pride of your family, but also the pride of DM Company, and all of Brownsville.

BEATRICE
Yes, yes, of course. Ruby is truly remarkable. And with a catch like Noah, she's brought honor to our whole family.

DAVID
(looking confused)
Ruby? No, I'm talking about the other Miss Winters. Where is she? I heard she's already here.

NOAH
Another Miss Winters?

DAVID
Yes. We can’t have any disruptions to today’s signing ceremony. Our company's future growth depends entirely on her.

NOAH
(pointing at Ashley's back)
Mr. Porter besides these troublemakers, there’s no one else here.

Ashley turns around imposingly. David sees her and freezes in shock, almost speechless.

DAVID
The troublemaker you mentioned is...is her?

NOAH
Yes, but don't worry. We'll have these pests thrown out right away.

David staggers back, steadied by his bodyguards.

NOAH (CONT’D)
Listen, you little bitch, Mr. Porter is here now. Weren't you bragging about how he'd bow down to you or something? Well, keep bragging!

ASHLEY
Mr. Porter, is this the top employee that you recommended?

David bows to Ashley apologetically.

DAVID
I'm sorry, Miss Winters! Please punish me as you see fit.

Everyone is shocked.

**Episode 25**

53 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 53

Ashley nods at David.

SELENA
Mr. Porter, what are you doing? Why are you bowing to this wretch?

DAVID
Silence! How dare you disrespect Miss Winters?

NOAH
Mr. Porter, you don't understand - she's just a prostitute who sells herself for money.

RUBY
That's right, she was just pretending to be the Chairman of AO Group.

DAVID
Pretending?

David looks at Ashley, who shakes her head at him.

DAVID (V.O.)
It seems the Chairman doesn't want to reveal her identity just yet. I'd better not expose her.

VINCENT
Exactly, and she's been disrespectful to you and the Chairman. She really doesn't know her place.

ASHLEY
(calmly)
But it looks like David has no intention of punishing me.

BEATRICE
This is outrageous! How dare you be so arrogant in front of Mr. Porter?

VINCENT
I'm telling you, Mr. Porter won't let you get away with impersonating the Chairman.

ASHLEY
Oh, is that so?

Ashley looks at David, who wipes away sweat from his brow.

RUBY
Drop the act already.

NOAH
Even at a time like this, you still look so calm. I have to admire your acting skills.

DAVID
(angrily)
Shut your mouth!

**Episode 26**

54 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 54

NOAH
Mr. Porter, what's wrong? Have you made a mistake?

SELENA
Don't be angry, Mr. Porter. I'll throw her out right away so she doesn’t offend your eyes.

NOAH
That’s right. She’s causing trouble before the VIP’s have gotten here—and look, she's even upset Mr. Porter. I'll remove her and her daughter right away.

DAVID
Stop right there!

NOAH
What's the matter?

DAVID
You fool, do you know who you're trying to have thrown out?

NOAH
Isn't she just some worthless woman who I rejected?

DAVID
You stupid idiot! Your whole family is useless! Do you realize she could take everything from you with just one word?

NOAH
Mr. Porter, you must be mistaken. She has no authority to do that. She's just a streetwalker I discarded like an old shoe.

David slaps Noah across the face. Noah is stunned.

SELENA
Mr. Porter, what is the meaning of this?

NOAH
(lowering his voice, to Selena)
I get it now - Mr. Porter must be one of Ashley's former clients.

SELENA
Ah, yes, yes, that must be it. I'm sorry, Mr. Porter. This is all my fault.

Selena laughs nervously. Noah leans in close to David with a smirk.

NOAH
Don't worry. I'll have someone send Ashley to your bed tonight.

David's face turns ashen.

DAVID
What did you just say?

David looks at Ashley, who has a serious expression.

NOAH
Mr. Porter, I totally get it. Man to man.

Noah grins maliciously. David slaps Noah across the face.

DAVID
Idiot!

**Episode 27**

55 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 55

Ashley shakes her head with a cold smile. Noah looks confused. Ruby supports Noah, her eyes darting as realization hits.

RUBY
(quietly to Noah)
Don’t say such things out loud.
(to David)
Ah, Mr. Porter, you're right to be angry. After all, Ashley is just scum that anyone can step on. And you’re a highly-respected manager - how could she possibly be worthy of you?

NOAH
(sudden realization)
I see, dear—how could someone so lowly be worthy of Mr. Porter?

RUBY
No wonder Mr. Porter is angry. I bet this little hussy tried to seduce him, and when she failed, she tried to force herself on him.

VINCENT
I'll have someone throw them out right now.

ASHLEY
(raising an eyebrow)
Oh? Let’s see if you have what it takes.

RUBY
Do you really think David will really listen to a fake Chairman?

DAVID
A fake?

SELENA
That's right! Don't worry, we've already onto her schemes.

DAVID
She's not the AO Group Chairman? Then who is she?

David points at Ashley.

RUBY
Her? She's a complete nobody, a prostitute without any background.

David slaps Ruby across the face.

DAVID
Shut up, you fool!

**Episode 28**

56 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 56

Ruby, stunned and holding her face, turns to David.

RUBY
Mr. Porter, what are you doing?

NOAH
Yes, what is the meaning of this?

DAVID
You all...you're digging your own graves.

SELENA
Could it be that we misunderstood Mr. Porter? Not only does he dislike Ashley, but it seems he utterly despises her. And yet, here we were, pushing her onto him—that was definitely asking for trouble.

NOAH
Yes, yes. I apologize, Mr. Porter. Since you have no interest in Ashley, I have nothing to worry about. I know this wretch better than anyone. To be honest, she's my ex-girlfriend.

David's face darkens.

NOAH (CONT'D)
But rest assured, I don't have anything to do with her anymore.

DAVID
So you don't associate with her.

NOAH
That's right. She worked as a prostitute for ten years. Now, she's pretending to be the Chairman of AO Group, trying to win me back. I rejected her.

DAVID (V.O.)
(his face ashen)
I get it. The Chairman didn't come here to reconcile with Noah, and yet I secretly promoted him. This idiot is going to ruin me.

NOAH
(passionate)
Before you arrived, we were just about to punish her.

Ashley smirks coldly, off to the side. David wipes sweat off his brow as he listens.

DAVID
Enough! Do you have any idea who she really is?

SELENA
Who she is? I know better than anyone—I'm her aunt. She's just a hick with a dead father and a cleaning lady for a mother.

VINCENT
Exactly! Pretending to be the Chairman of AO Group? Ridiculous!

BEATRICE
Mr. Porter, don't worry. I've already cut all ties with her. She's no longer part of the Winters family, so you can deal with her as you see fit.

David, enraged, is at a loss for words.

DAVID
You—I can't believe you people!

RUBY
Mr. Porter, I understand. We didn't deal with this imposter in time and now you're angry. It's our fault. Don't worry, we'll punish her.

NOAH
(nodding fervently)
Yes, yes, we'll make sure of it.

DAVID
(face flushed)
You people are the real troublemakers! You're the ones who need to be punished!

He turns to Ashley.

DAVID (CONT'D)
I deeply apologize, Ms. Winters. How should we deal with these people?

Ashley smirks coldly. Noah, Ruby, Selena, and Beatrice are utterly shocked.

**Episode 29**

57 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 57

ASHLEY
AO Group's employment standards value moral character above all else. Scum like this doesn't deserve to work for AO Group.

DAVID
Understood. Take back all the gifts!

David waves his hand, and his bodyguards take back all the gifts.

DAVID (CONT'D)
Noah Fletcher, you are fired for falsifying your academic credentials.

RUBY
What? Fired?

NOAH
Mr. Porter, you must be mistaken!

VINCENT
Yeah, what do you mean?

NOAH
I graduated from a prestigious university. My credentials are legit!

DAVID
Real? We've already investigated and confirmed that you falsified your academic record. If it weren't for the banquet tonight, you'd have been fired long ago.

NOAH
So what if I faked my degree? Does the company plan to overlook the fact that I was the top performer in the entire company?

DAVID
Do you think I'm a fool? Your so-called top performance comes from kickbacks and under-the-table deals with clients. Someone who cons his way into the top sales spot has no place in AO Group. Let me repeat: Noah Fletcher, you are fired!

Noah collapses onto the floor.

NOAH
(breaking down)
Did I really just get fired? There must be some mistake! Wasn't I supposed to get promoted, get a raise, and receive shares in company stock? Today was supposed to be the day I entered the upper-class!

DAVID
Yes, today was supposed to be a glorious day for you. But you ruined it yourself.

NOAH
No! No! Mr. Porter, please, give me another chance!

Noah grabs David's leg, but David kicks him away.

DAVID
Get lost, you idiot!

NOAH
No, this can’t be right. My promotion and shares were personally approved by the AO Group Chairman. I received the official notice from Mr. Taylor, the company’s HR Manager. You’re just a manager of DM Company—you don’t have the authority to fire me!

DAVID
You little—!

Noah bursts into laughter.

NOAH
Hah! You almost scared me for a moment there!

ASHLEY
He doesn’t have the authority. I do.

Ashley dials a number on her phone.

ASHLEY (CONT’D)
Mark Taylor, you have 30 seconds to revoke Noah Fletcher’s contract and his stock ownership.

NOAH
(mocking)
You’re quite the actor! Do you really think you’re the AO Group Chairman?

Noah’s phone rings. He looks delighted.

NOAH (CONT’D)
Look at that—it’s Mr. Taylor! The Chairman must’ve contacted him to give me an update.

Noah answers the call.

NOAH (CONT’D)
Hello, Mr. Taylor. What is it?

TAYLOR (V.O.)
What on earth did you do? The Chairman just called me personally to revoke your promotion and take back your stock shares!

NOAH
What?!

Noah stumbles back in shock. Ryan snatches the contract from his hand.

NOAH (CONT'D)
Could it be...are you actually the Chairman of AO Group!?

**Episode 30**

58 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 58

ASHLEY
That's right. At least you're not completely stupid.

Ashley smirks coldly as Noah collapses backward onto the floor.

NOAH
It's over...it's all over.

Selena and Vincent also slump to the ground.

SELENA & VINCENT
It's over.

Beatrice staggers, unsteady on her feet, while Ruby grabs her phone and walks out.

59 EXT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY 59

Ruby makes a phone call.

RUBY
Hey, Jessica. I need you to do something for me.

Ruby hangs up, her eyes filled with malice.

RUBY (V.O.)
You're dead, Ashley.

**Episode 31**

60 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 60

NOAH
Ashley, I was wrong. I really was wrong. For the sake all the years we spent growing up together, please forgive me this once.

Noah speaks as he crawls toward Ashley, grabbing the hem of her dress. Ashley pulls away in disgust. Ruby walks in from the door.

RUBY
You've all been deceived by this wretch.

NOAH
Ruby, you mean...

RUBY
Isn't it obvious? Mr. Porter must have been bewitched by this wretched woman, which is why he's playing along with this act. There's no way she's the chairman of AO Group.

ASHLEY
And how can you be so sure that I'm not the chairman?

RUBY
Perhaps you don't know this, but the chairman of AO Group is my best friend, who just got back from Europe.

Noah, Selena, and Vincent are all stunned.

61 INT. AIRPLANE CABIN - DAY 61

Orion sits back in his chair.

JACK
President, the plane is about to take off. You'll need to turn off your phone.

Orion hands his phone to Jack, who powers it down.

ORION
Is the welcome gift ready?

JACK
Don’t worry, President. The five gifts you’ve prepared for Madam are all en route.

ORION
Good. Speed it up. I promised Madam I’d arrive at the signing banquet before noon.

JACK
Understood.

**Episode 32**

62 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 62

RUBY
My best friend, the chairman of AO Group, will be here soon. So you’re in big trouble, you little bitch.

NOAH
I knew it. How could a prostitute possibly be the Chairman?

Noah stands up, adjusts his clothes, and instantly adopts an arrogant stance.

NOAH (CONT’D)
Ruby, why didn’t you say his earlier?

VINCENT
A manager of DM is nothing next to the Chairman of AO Group.

DAVID
What kind of imposter did you find? Miss Winters is the real chairman of AO Group.

Selena and Vincent also stand up, with smug expressions.

SELENA
Mr. Porter, I suggest not to let this woman deceive you. Don’t pick the wrong side and ruin your life.

DAVID
Enough! You’re digging your own graves!

Marina, frightened, pulls on Ashley's arm.

MARINA
Ashley, maybe we should just leave. If they really are close to the Chairman, I'm afraid they'll hurt you when she arrives.

Selena blocks Ashley and Marina's path.

SELENA
Leave? It's too late for that now.

ASHLEY
Don't be afraid, Mom. If we back down, scum like them will only get emboldened. The next time they bully someone, they'll be even more outrageous.

SELENA
Still so stubborn even in the face of your own doom?

NOAH
A prostitute and a cleaning lady—lowly scum like you deserve to be bullied and stepped on.

ASHLEY
So just because we're lower-class, we deserve your contempt? Today, I'll tell you this—being born lower-class is not a sin. It's your wicked behavior that's truly sinful!

VINCENT
Looks like you're determined to stay arrogant until the end.

BEATRICE
Considering that you've called me "grandmother" all these years, I'll give you some advice: know your place and leave!

ASHLEY
If I were to leave, this banquet would be meaningless. I'm quite looking forward to seeing how this imposter acts.

JESSICA (O.S.)
Who dares to impersonate me? The audacity!

Everyone turns to look toward the door. JESSICA makes a commanding entrance with six black-suited bodyguards. She is dressed in a bright, bold red dress adorned with sparkling jewels, exuding an air of grandeur.

**Episode 33**

63 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 63

Jessica makes a dazzling entrance. David looks at her, utterly shocked.

BEGIN FLASHBACK:

64 INT. HOTEL - DAY 64

Jessica wraps her arms around David's neck as the two share an intimate moment.

END FLASHBACK.

65 INT. PROMOTION BANQUET HALL - DAY 65

David wipes the sweat from his forehead.

DAVID (V.O.)
What is she doing here!? At a time like this?

66 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 66

VINCENT
Ruby, the chairman you mentioned… is this her?

RUBY
That's right, Dad. Why?

Vincent looks flustered.

BEGIN FLASHBACK:

67 INT. RESTAURANT - DAY 67

Jessica, looking seductive, wraps her arms around Vincent as they get intimate.

END FLASHBACK.

68 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY 68

Vincent's face is full of embarrassment as he exchanges glances with Jessica.

VINCENT
Nothing. I'm going to the restroom to deal with...uh, something!

Vincent covers his face as he quickly slips out through the crowd. Jessica's gaze just barely misses him.

Ruby beams with excitement and rushes up to Jessica.

RUBY
Jessica, you're here! Everyone, this is Miss Vale, the chairman of the global conglomerate AO Group.

The crowd breaks into murmurs.

SELENA
Oh my, as expected of the chairman of a global conglomerate like AO Group. So noble, so elegant. Such extraordinary grace.

Selena throws a disdainful glance at Ashley.

SELENA (CONT'D)
Unlike some people—no matter how much trash dresses itself up, it still reeks of poverty.

JESSICA
Oh, Mrs. Hart, you flatter me. But tell me, what exactly happened here?

69 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 69

SELENA
(tearfully)
Miss Vale, you must stand up for us. We're being bullied by this wretched woman!

Selena clutches her face dramatically.

NOAH
Miss Vale, this Ashley woman is impersonating you. You can't let her off easily!

JESSICA
Who has such audacity?

NOAH
Her! Over there!

Jessica looks over at Ashley.

NOAH (CONT'D)
She's just a filthy little bitch—a poor nobody whose father died, burdened with a sick, useless mother. After I dumped her, she caught some disgusting disease like the trash she is!

JESSICA
A clown with no education, no social connections, and no capital? And she dares to pretend to be me, the Chairman of AO Group? How ridiculous.

SELENA
Exactly! She's in way over her head—where does she get the nerve to impersonate you?

RUBY
Now that she's seen the real chairman, she must finally see the gap between you two.

Ashley calmly sizes up Jessica and smirks coldly.

ASHLEY
The gap is indeed vast. Are you certain she's the chairman?

Jessica turns toward David, whose eyes nervously shift away.

JESSICA
Mr. Porter, why don't you tell us? Am I or am I not the chairman of AO Group?

Jessica and Ashley both stare at David. David wipes his sweat nervously.

DAVID
You're...

JESSICA
Go on! Who am I?

David hesitates, then steels himself.

DAVID
That's right. This is the real chairman of AO Group, Jessica Vale.

Ashley looks stunned and disbelieving.

**Episode 35**

70 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 70

ASHLEY
David, you'd better think before you speak.

DAVID
Miss Winters, I'm resigning as manager. Please forgive me. Something has come up at home, so I must take my leave.

Ashley is stunned as David hurriedly exits with his bodyguards.

SELENA
Looks like your supporter has run off. Ha! Let's see how tough you can act now.

NOAH
(beaming)
Miss Vale, there's one thing I don't understand. Earlier, AO Group's HR manager said I was to be fired, and my shares were to be revoked. What's that all about?

JESSICA
Isn't it obvious? The termination is only temporary. I plan to transfer you to our New York headquarters and have you work directly under my supervision. From now on, you'll be working closely with me on core business operations. Isn't that far better than staying in this little DM company as a salesperson?

NOAH
(overjoyed)
What? Transferring to New York headquarters and working by your side? Thank you, Miss Vale, for recognizing my talents!

SELENA
(ecstatic)
In that position, you'd outrank Mr. Porter right? Oh, Miss Vale, you really have a keen eye! Noah is a once-in-a-lifetime talent.

NOAH
(to Ashley, smugly)
See that? Your minion David can't protect you now. If you know what's good for you, take your sick mother and get out of my sight!

ASHLEY
I wasn't planning to argue with you any further, but now it seems I really must see this through.

She turns to Zoe.

ASHLEY (CONT'D)
Zoe, you have half an hour. I want every piece of information on this impostor standing before me.

ZOE
Understood.

Zoe exits.

**Episode 36**

71 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 71

NOAH
I can't believe how arrogant you are, you imposter! How dare you to speak so rudely to the Chairwoman!

ASHLEY
I'm not going to even bother to argue with a clown like you.

JESSICA
Such bold words. You know, after just one command from me, you and your mother wouldn't even find a job cleaning toilets in Brownsville.

SELENA
Miss Vale, you should teach this impostor a lesson.

NOAH
This vile woman just tried to persuade Mr. Porter to fire me. I'm just a regular person, so it's not much to me. But this is a grave insult to AO Group, and an insult to you!

JESSICA
Apologize to Mr. Fletcher immediately, or I'll use my network to make sure you and your mother can't find a foothold anywhere on continent!

ASHLEY
Apologize to him? He doesn't deserve that.

SELENA
Ungrateful bitch! Miss Vale is giving you a second chance by letting you apologize.

NOAH
That's right. If you wait until the richest man in the world gets here, even if you beg for forgiveness, it'll be too late.

ASHLEY
When he arrives, you'll be the ones bowing and begging for forgiveness. Not me.

NOAH
What a joke! Just because you managed to fool someone as stupid as David, you think you can charm every man in the world?

SELENA
Mr. Vale is a man of high standing. Why in the world would he ever stand up for you?

ASHLEY
Because I am his fiancée.

Noah, Ruby, Selena, and Beatrice are all stunned.

**Episode 37**

72 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 72

RUBY
You're crazy! You, the fiancée of the world's richest man? Why don't you just fly to the moon while you're at it?

NOAH
First you claim to be the Chairman of AO Group, and now you're saying you're Mr. Vale's fiancée? I have to admit, your audacity is truly something else.

BEATRICE
You delusional little bitch! You better beg Miss Vale for forgiveness now. Maybe she'll be generous enough to let you off just this once.

ASHLEY
Me, beg a fraud like her for forgiveness? Don't even think about it.

NOAH
You're really stubborn, aren't you? Mr. Vale will be here soon.
(MORE)

NOAH (CONT'D)
I suggest you apologize to Miss Vale immediately, or when Mr. Vale arrives, your fate will be a hundred times worse.

Marina tries to pull Ashley away.

MARINA
Ashley, maybe we should just leave.

ASHLEY
Mom, don't be afraid. The Mr. Vale they're talking about is your son-in-law. I'll call him right now.

Ashley calls Orion, but the call doesn't go through.

73 EXT. LUXURY CAR - DAY 73

Jack opens the car door for Orion, who stands outside the car, about to get in, when Jack stops him.

JACK
President, I just received word that the diamond ring you wanted, The Pink Star has been secured at the Christie's auction for $72 million.

ORION
Good. Take some men and go pick it up personally. There can't be any mishaps. I want to surprise my wife with it at the banquet tonight.

JACK
Understood.

Jack leaves with a group of bodyguards, and Orion gets into the car.

**Episode 38**

74 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY 74

Ashley ends the call, frowning.

NOAH
What's wrong, couldn't get through? What a show. As if you'd have the number of the world's richest ma.

SELENA
Oh, I'm just trembling with fear. You really think a hooker off the streets can order the world's richest man around?

RUBY
That call was probably just to one of her bedmates, haha!

ASHLEY
Believe what you want. He's on his jet now. He'll be here soon.

SELENA
I think you should save yourself the effort of trying to climb above your station. Your ambition is laughable.

JESSICA
Impersonating me wasn't enough? Now you're inventing a fiancé who happens to be the world's richest man? Utterly ridiculous.

NOAH
This worthless woman must have lost her mind after I dumped her. Ha!

ASHLEY
You'll see soon enough - today's laughing stock isn't me, it's you.

BEATRICE
Fine, we'll wait. I want to see if you can actually summon the world's richest man.

Ashley glances at the wall clock - ten minutes to noon.

ASHLEY
Don't worry. Orion promised he'd be here by noon. He never breaks his word.

**Episode 39**

75 INT. LUXURY CAR - DAY 75

ORION (V.O.)
Ashley, this time I'm definitely making you my wife.

Orion turns on his phone, sees Ashley's missed call.

ORION
Ashley called.

He quickly dials her back.

ORION (CONT'D)
Hello, darling.

76 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY 76

ASHLEY
If you don't show up soon, I'm gonna be bullied me to death.

77 INT. LUXURY CAR - DAY 77

ORION
Darling, don't be mad. I'm almost there.
(to driver)
Faster!

78 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY 78

Ashley ends the call.

ASHLEY
See? He said he's almost here.

NOAH
Empty threats. You think this little act scares me? I know exactly what trash you are.

ASHLEY
Whether I'm bluffing or not - you'll find out soon enough.

SELENA
A street hooker like you isn't even worthy of polishing that man's shoes, let alone summoning him.

ASHLEY
Is that so? What if I told you not only will the world's richest man come, but he'll do exactly as I say?

**Episode 40**

79 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 79

SELENA
You’re all bark and no bite. So desperate to make yourself seem important.

BEATRICE
If you had that kind of power, you and your janitor mother wouldn't be skulking around here.

Ashley gives a cold smile.

JESSICA
(whispers to Ruby)
She couldn't actually get the world's richest man here... could she?

RUBY
(whispers back)
Impossible. I just checked - he's at an international conference in Arabia. He can't possibly come. She's just putting on an act. Keep playing along.

Jessica and Ruby exchange knowing looks. Jessica regains her composure.

RUBY (CONT’D)
One can pretend for a moment, but you can't fake it forever. Time to wake up from your delusions of grandeur.

JESSICA
I’ll tell you right now - Orion Vale, the world's richest man, is my fiancé. We've kept it private for business reasons.

The crowd buzzes with gossip.

GUEST A
They say Mr. Vale is temperamental and eccentric, completely uninterested in women.
(MORE)

GUEST A (CONT'D)
His romantic life's been a complete mystery - turns out he's been secretly engaged to the AO Group's chairwoman all along.

GUEST B
My word, they're perfect for each other. Their union will create a dynasty of business legends.

SELENA
What a powerful alliance, truly a match made in heaven.

NOAH
I had no idea you had such a connection to the world's richest man. Mrs. Vale, I hope you'll put in a good word for us.

Jessica lifts her chin proudly.

JESSICA
Of course. However, my fiancé Mr. Vale is currently at an international conference. He won't be attending today.

**Episode 41**

80 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 80

ASHLEY
(with cold amusement)
You're certain the world's richest man is your fiancé?

JESSICA
(smugly)
That's right. He even said he'd transfer all his shares to me.

ASHLEY
Oh, what a coincidence - he told me the exact same thing.

SELENA
Truth can't become lies, and lies can't become truth. It's almost noon - where's this world's richest boyfriend of yours?

ASHLEY
No rush. We still have five minutes.

NOAH
This bitch has always been full of lies. She's clearly stalling, trying to ruin both the signing ceremony and my promotion!

JESSICA
I don’t think we need to wait any further. The ceremonies are more important. We should remove these irrelevant people immediately.

ASHLEY
If you're really the chairwoman, why’re you in such a rush? Can't spare five minutes? Perhaps you have something to hide?

Ashley fixes Jessica with an unwavering stare.

**Episode 42**

81 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 81

SELENA
You bitch, dare to disrespect Mrs. Vale again and I'll rip your mouth open!

NOAH
Get your sick mother and leave while you can. If Mrs Vale loses her temper, no one can save you.

BEATRICE
The promotion ceremony's about to begin. Why waste more words on her? Mrs Vale, please help us deal with these two pieces of garbage.

JESSICA
Guards!

Two bodyguards rush over.

JESSICA (CONT'D)
Didn't you hear the lady? She doesn't want to see these two cursed people anymore. Drag them out immediately.

The bodyguards move to grab Ashley and Marina. Marina steps in front of Ashley protectively.

MARINA
What are you doing? No one touches my daughter!

ASHLEY
Orion will be here any moment. You'll all pay for what you've done.

JESSICA
So stubborn. I'd love to see how you make us pay.

As Ashley and Marina are being dragged away, they struggle desperately.

ASHLEY
Let go of me!

MARINA
Let go of my daughter!

ORION (O.S.)
Who dares lay a hand on my fiancée?!

Everyone turns toward the entrance as Orion appears, radiating authority.

**Episode 43**

82 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 82

Ashley and Marina break free from their restraints. Orion rushes over to help Ashley up.

ORION
I'm sorry, darling. I'm late.

ASHLEY
It's fine. You're right on time. If you'd come earlier, you'd have missed this fantastic show.

GUEST A
Did she actually summon the richest man in the world?

GUEST B
Who knows if he's really the richest man in the world or not?

ORION
How dare you bully my fiancée? You'll all pay for this.

Noah, Ruby, and Jessica freeze in shock. Selena stares, puzzled.

SELENA (V.O.)
Why does he look so familiar?

FLASHBACK BEGINS

83 INT. RESTAURANT - DAY 83

Ten years ago, Orion is seen carrying Ashley away.

FLASHBACK ENDS

84 INT. PROMOTION PARTY BANQUET HALL - DAY 84

SELENA
So it's him.

Selena's face breaks into a sinister smile.

**Episode 44**

85 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 85

Selena approaches Orion.

SELENA
So this is your billionaire fiancé? I'm so...terrified.

Selena circles Orion, scrutinizing him.

SELENA (CONT'D)
You can fool others, but not me. Isn't he the same uncultured man who took you away ten years ago?

NOAH
Oh, it's him? That irrelevant boy from back then.

RUBY
Dressed all fancy, huh? Must've blown a fortune just to keep up appearances.

NOAH
Probably broke as hell. I bet he doesn't even have a decent gift to show.

SELENA
You're a perfect match. Your man is just like you: a nobody that's full of lies and bullshit.

ORION
I did prepare a gift. It's just on its way.

JESSICA
Lies on top of lies. Today, let me show you two poor idiots what true wealth looks like—what a real gift is.

ORION
Oh? When it comes to wealth, I've never been afraid of anyone.

JESSICA
How shameless. Open your eyes, mutt, and take a good look.

Jessica raises her hands high above her head and claps.

JESSICA (CONT'D)
Bring it over here.

A female assistant walks in, carrying an elegant jewelry box. She opens it, revealing a stunning necklace to Ruby.

JESSICA (CONT'D)
Ruby, here's a little gift I brought you from Europe. It's the "Blue Ocean Star" necklace.

**Episode 45**

86 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 86

GUEST A
I heard that the “Blue Ocean Star” is the masterpiece of the world-renowned jewelry designer Roberta Wolfers.

GUEST B
This necklace combines original intaglio and inner painting techniques with gemstones. It’s one of a kind, and worth at least 20 million dollars.

GUEST A
As expected of a chairwoman of a global conglomerate. So generous. Why don’t we have friends like that?

ASHLEY
“Blue Ocean Star...?”

FLASHBACK BEGINS

Orion places the “Blue Ocean Star” necklace around Ashley’s neck.

FLASHBACK ENDS

87 INT. PROMOTION PARTY BANQUET HALL - DAY 87

JESSICA
How about that? A gift like this—something you and your broke fiancé couldn’t afford in a lifetime.

ASHLEY
(smirking coldly)
It’s nothing but a fake necklace.

**Episode 46**

88 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 88

JESSICA (V.O.)
How does she know? I can’t let this slip.

ORION
If I’m not mistaken, the real necklace was bought by the world’s richest man at a Sotheby’s auction.

NOAH
You broke fuck. You and your little mistress are dressed from head to toe in knock-offs. High-end necklaces like this? I’m afraid you’ve never set eyes on one before.

ASHLEY
Covered in fakes, are we?

SELENA
Exactly! And you dare to question the chairwoman’s necklace? How fucking hilarious.

ASHLEY
I recommend you get your eyes checked.

RUBY
Honey, don’t listen to her. You’re so good to me—I absolutely love it.

Ruby takes the necklace and pretends to kiss Jessica on the cheek.

JESSICA
(whispers to Ruby)
What do we do?

RUBY
(whispering back)
Don’t panic. Just stick to your story. You’re the chairwoman. She’s just a roadside prostitute with no background or connections. What can she do to you?

Jessica nods and adjusts her expression.

JESSICA
This necklace? It was a gift to me from the world’s richest man.

Orion starts to speak, but Ashley stops him.

ASHLEY
The world's richest man gave it to you? Oh, then how about this one?

Ashley pulls the scarf from her neck, revealing the true "Blue Ocean Star" necklace.

Jessica stares at the necklace in shock as murmurs ripple through the crowd.

**Episode 47**

89 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 89

GUEST A
Two identical necklaces. Which one's real?

GUEST B
Isn't it obvious? Of course, it's Miss Vale's. Like it could belong to that street slut.

JESSICA
(furious)
Wearing a fake necklace and daring to show off here? Let me teach you a lesson, you bitch!

Jessica steps closer to Ashley and yanks the necklace off her neck.

ORION
What are you doing?!

Orion moves to grab the necklace, but two bodyguards block him. Jessica holds up the necklace with a vicious glare.

JESSICA
How dare you deceive me with a fake in front of everyone? I'll expose you right now!

ASHLEY
That happens to be the real "Blue Ocean Star". I suggest you handle it carefully.

JESSICA
You're not seriously going to claim that the world's richest man gave it to you, are you?

ASHLEY
You said it yourself.

JESSICA
You mean this piece of useless trash standing right here? Oh, I'm so scared!

ASHLEY
At least you're not completely clueless.

JESSICA
So courageous! Pretending to be me and fantasizing about having a billionaire boyfriend? If I don't teach you a lesson today, I'll disgrace my title as Chairwoman of the AO Group!

Jessica throws the necklace to the floor and prepares to step on it.

JESSICA (CONT'D)
A cheap trinket from a street stall, and you dare to parade it around here?!

Orion steps aside, pulling out his phone. He begins dialing.

ORION
Jack, send me the "Blue Ocean Star" authentication certificate immediately.

**Episode 48**

90 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 90

ASHLEY
You'd better think this through. You step on that, and it's 20 million gone. Better not do something you'll regret.

JESSICA
Looks like you're willing to die on this hill.

Jessica raises her foot, about to step on Ashley's necklace.

ASHLEY
I'm warning you. If you destroy it, you won't be able to handle the consequences. The price is secondary—what matters most is that this is the token of love my fiancé gave me.

NOAH
(laughing)
You want me to worry about some worthless shit you bought at the dollar store?

BEATRICE
To use a broken chain worth 10 dollars and claim that your love is stronger than gold. How shameless.

ASHLEY
I'll say it one more time. It's real. If you break it, I swear I'll never forgive you.

SELENA
This is a first for me—someone flaunting a fake and acting so crazy over it.

JESSICA
Fake goods belong in the trash. Watch this.

Jessica throws the necklace on the floor and stomps on it hard. She stands with her hands on her hips, looking smugly at Ashley. Ashley tries to step forward, but Selena and Ruby hold her back.

JESSICA (CONT'D)
Go ahead, keep pretending! You said it's real? Fine, if it's real, I'll pick up piece by piece and eat it for you!

Ashley burns with anger.

ASHLEY
Remember what you just said. That wish is about to come true.

Orion rushes back into the hall. He shoves Selena and Ruby aside.

ORION
Let her go! Who said the necklace was fake? here’s the certificate.

Orion holds up his phone, showing it to the crowd.

**Episode 49**

91 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 91

The crowd murmurs in shock. Noah, Selena, Jessica, and Ruby are shocked.

NOAH
How is that possible? A fake certificate can’t prove it’s real!

ORION
This certificate has a verification code. Scan it, and you’ll know the truth. It’s authenticated by the International Jewelry Appraisal Center.

NOAH
That necklace was bought by the richest man at auction. Only he would have the authentication code. Could he really be… that richest man?

SELENA
No way. How could a prostitute like her possibly land the richest man?

A BODYGUARD runs into the hall to report to Orion.

BODYGUARD
President, the welcome gifts you prepared for Miss Winters have arrived.

ORION
Bring them in.

A line of FOUR HOSTESSES enters through the door, walking in perfect formation. Each holds a tray. On the trays are an emerald gemstone, a pearl necklace, a property deed, and a black card.

CLOSE-UP: The vibrant emerald sparkles under the light.

BODYGUARD (V.O.)
The first gift: a top-grade emerald gemstone.

GUEST A
What? A top-grade emerald? That's worth at least tens of millions!

CLOSE-UP: The exquisite necklace, adorned with 56 natural wild pearls, each encrusted with diamonds and rubies.

BODYGUARD (V.O.)
The second gift: the "Royal Wanderer" pearl necklace.

GUEST A
The "Royal Wanderer" was crafted 500 years ago and has been in the British royal collection ever since!

GUEST B
This… this is priceless. Who exactly is this guy?

BODYGUARD (V.O.)
The third gift: a mansion in Beverly Hills, Los Angeles.

GUEST A
What? The luxury homes there start at hundreds of millions, and only the top three in the world's wealthiest people are eligible to buy them.

GUEST B
Who exactly is he?

BODYGUARD (V.O.)
The fourth gift: a 4S-level unlimited global supreme black card.

The hostesses carefully place each gift on the table.

NOAH
Isn't that the 4A supreme black card that's only reserved for the world's richest man? Could he really be… the richest man?

**Episode 50**

92 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 92

SELENA
What?!

Noah and Selena recoil in shock.

ORION
(to Marina)
Mrs. Winters, just a small token. I hope you won't find it too modest.

MARINA
Of course not! These are far too precious.

NOAH
These-- these are all for that old woman?!

SELENA
I can't believe it… That bitch actually snagged the richest man?!

Jessica approaches the gifts, clapping mockingly.

JESSICA
Amazing. This performance is truly amazing. Most people would be fooled by all this, but don't think for a second you can fool me.

NOAH
Miss Vale, what are you saying?

JESSICA
Isn't it obvious? These so-called gifts are all fakes! Bringing plastic trinkets here to show off? What a fucking joke!

Jessica casually picks up the emerald gemstone.

ORION
I'd suggest you handle that carefully. If you break it, you can't afford to pay for it.

JESSICA
Oh really? Ten bucks for a sack of this stuff, and you think I can't afford it?

Jessica tosses the gemstone to the floor and stomps on it, shattering it.

ORION
(furious)
You!

JESSICA
And this? A bunch of two-dollar plastic beads?

Jessica rips the necklace. Pearls scatter across the floor.

JESSICA (CONT'D)
And this counterfeit property deed you could've printed anywhere, alongside some cheap gaming card? You dare call these priceless gifts?

Jessica tears the property deed in half and snaps the black card, throwing both onto the ground.

**Episode 51**

93 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 93

Noah arrogantly steps closer to Ashley and Orion.

NOAH
I should've known. How could a pauper suddenly turn into a prince?
(jabbing Orion's chest)
How could a pig like you afford something so expensive? I almost believed your lies.

SELENA
Fake? But Miss Vale, the "Blue Ocean Star" necklace you just broke was proven to be real.

JESSICA
I was just about to say: the necklace was stolen. I bet she fucked the billionaire's butler so she could break into his house and steal it.

The crowd gasps, murmuring in shock.

NOAH
What?!

JESSICA
The “Blue Ocean Star” is the love token Orion gave to me. Who would’ve thought this slut would steal it from me?

SELENA
Oh, of course. I was wondering how someone as poor as her could have a necklace worth millions.

NOAH
Ashley, oh Ashley, I thought you were just vain, but I didn’t expect you’d stoop so low as to become a thief.

SELENA
Someone with such a disgraceful record, Miss Vale, should be locked up.

BEATRICE
Exactly! Of all the people to steal from, you had to pick Miss Vale?
(to Miss Vale)
Don’t hold back on account of your reputation. Better teach her a proper fucking lesson.

JESSICA
Didn’t you hear that? Arrest these two thieves already!

Two bodyguards step forward to grab Ashley and Orion. They struggle against them.

ORION
Let go!

Marina steps in front of Ashley to shield her.

MARINA
Don’t you dare touch my daughter!

One of the bodyguards shoves Marina aside.

ASHLEY
Mom!

JACK (O.S.)
Stop right there! You’ve got some big fucking guts!

Jack enters with two bodyguards, exuding authority.

**Episode 52**

94 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 94

The crowd immediately removes their hats and bows in respect. Ruby and Jessica are dumbfounded.

GUEST A
Isn't that Mr. Merritt, the personal assistant to the richest man in the world? It's an honor to meet you, sir!

Ashley and Marina break free from their restraints. Selena's entire face glows with joy.

SELENA
Oh my, Miss Vale, you're truly amazing! To have Mr. Merritt personally show up.

Jessica smiles awkwardly.

NOAH
Mr. Merritt, you've arrived at the perfect time. These two thieves not only stole Miss Vale's necklace but had their uncultured boytoy haul in a bunch of fake goods to flaunt their so-called wealth.

SELENA
Luckily, Miss Vale was sharp enough to catch on. Just in time, she already destroyed all of that junk.

Jack glances at the destroyed gifts on the floor, horrified.

JACK
What? You destroyed every single one of the gifts?

NOAH
That's right. Don't worry, sir. None of that trash was overlooked. We made sure it was thoroughly dealt with.

Noah gestures to the shattered gifts on the floor. Jack slaps Noah across the face.

JACK
Who gave you the right?!

NOAH
Mr. Merritt, w-what are you doing?

Selena glances nervously at Noah, her eyes shifting as she realizes something.

SELENA
Ah… hahaha… Mr. Merritt, this is… this is clearly our fault for not taking care of these things properly.

NOAH
Don’t worry, sir. We were just about to send these two thieves to the police.

JACK
You dare touch the president and his wife? You must have a death wish!

Noah, Selena, Ruby, and Beatrice freeze in shock, utterly stunned.

**Episode 53**

95 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 95

NOAH
President? Madam?

SELENA
Mr. Merritt, you must be mistaken. What president and madam?

Jack scowls and shoves Noah aside.

JACK
Move.

Jack approaches Orion and Ashley, bowing respectfully.

JACK (CONT’D)
Apologies, President, Madam. I arrived late.

SELENA
What? He... he’s really the richest man in the world?

NOAH
Madam? That slut managed to hook up with the richest man on Earth?

RUBY
Could everything she said earlier actually be true?

BEATRICE
Then... are these gifts all real?

The crowd murmurs in disbelief.

JESSICA
Impossible. This absolutely cannot be true.

ORION
You group of blind trash. To be exact, I've already transferred all my shares into her name. She's now the true richest person in the world.

NOAH
What?!

Selena, Beatrice, Ruby, and the rest of the crowd are in shock. Noah stumbles back a few steps, horrified.

**Episode 54**

96 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 96

NOAH
She's just a whore! How could she be the richest person in the world?

Jack slaps Noah across the face.

JACK
How dare you question her status?

ORION
You blind son of a bitch. Spread the word: from this moment forward, Noah is blacklisted in every industry worldwide.

Noah collapses to the ground in despair.

ORION (CONT'D)
As for the rest of you, I made myself clear. I won't let off a single person who bullies Ashley.

Beatrice, broken, approaches Ashley.

BEATRICE
Ashley, my dear granddaughter, don't be like this. Please. After all, we're family. Forgive us, won't you?

ASHLEY
Family? You think you're worthy of being called my family? Have you forgotten? Ruby's the granddaughter you've always been so proud of.

BEATRICE
Don't say that, Ashley. You're Grandma's most outstanding granddaughter! Please, just forgive your cousin. Ruby, apologize to Ashley right now. Stop being so stubborn!

RUBY
No! Why should I apologize? Who does she think she is? Just because she's got some money?

SELENA
Mom, who the fuck does she think she is anyway? Her status is all because of a man!

RUBY
That's right! You must've used some dirty tricks to make Mr. Vale and Mr. Merritt lie for you!

Noah suddenly has a realization and scrambles to his feet.

NOAH
Exactly! Mr. Vale, don't be fooled by her! This slut is a master manipulator when it comes to men! Sir, don't let her deceive you!

97 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 97

ORION
My fiancée is not someone you're qualified to question.

SELENA
Don't get too full of yourself. When a man loves you, he'll give you the world. But when he doesn't, you're worth less than dirt.

NOAH
Exactly. The person I truly admire is the self-reliant and accomplished President of AO Group, Miss Vale.

Jessica, who's trying to slip away, forced to stop and feign composure when Noah mentions her.

JESSICA
Bitch! Sure, you might have men wrapped around your finger, but as the President of AO Group, I despise women like you who rely on men.

JACK
Who gave you the right to insult the madam like that?!

Jack steps forward, ready to confront Jessica, but Ashley stops him.

ASHLEY
So stubborn. You really want to keep up this charade? Let's see how long you can keep laughing.

Ashley pulls out her phone.

ASHLEY (CONT'D)
Zoe, I want Jessica's full background in one minute.

98 INT. ZOE'S LUXURY CAR - DAY 98

ZOE
Yes, Chairwoman. I've already uncovered her identity. I'm on my way back to the venue now.

**Episode 56**

99 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY 99

SELENA
You whore! Still putting on an act in front of Miss Vale?

RUBY
What could you possibly uncover?

NOAH
I can't stand this anymore. Miss Vale, why don't you just throw this braindead bitch out already?

JESSICA
Guards! Get them out of here!

ORION
I dare any of you to try.

BEATRICE
Mr. Vale, you may be the richest man in the world, but interfering in someone else's family matters is actually inappropriate. Miss Vale, please handle this however you see fit.

JESSICA
Didn't you hear the madam? Do it!

Jessica's bodyguards close in, surrounding the group.

ORION
You're digging your own grave. I was willing to spare you because you're Ashley's relatives, but now it's clear you don't deserve it. Jack?

JACK
Yes, sir.

Jack and two of Orion's bodyguards prepare to confront Jessica's guards.

ZOE (O.S.)
Stop!

The crowd turns to look. Zoe strides over with documents in hand.

**Episode 57**

100 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 100

Zoe's bodyguards quickly secure the scene, freeing Jack.

ZOE
Miss Winters, here's the information you requested.

Zoe leans in to whisper into Ashley's ear.

ASHLEY
Good.

ZOE
Everything is in here.

Zoe hands over a USB drive with both hands.

ASHLEY
Well, don't just stand there. Let everyone see.

ZOE
Yes, ma'am.

Zoe goes to set up the files. Jessica and Ruby begin to panic.

NOAH
You whore! What kind of tricks do you need to pull now?

JESSICA
Let's see what you've got, you little liar. See what you're using to back yourself up.

ASHLEY
Don't worry. You most definitely won't be disappointed.

The LED screen lights up, displaying photos and files. Zoe narrates each one.

The first image: Jessica, drunk and surrounded by empty bottles.

The second image: Jessica, gaunt and clearly high.

The third image: Jessica in prison, wearing an orange jumpsuit.

ZOE
Jessica Sterling. Born in the slums. A history of alcoholism, drug abuse, dropped out of school in middle school to work odd jobs, and multiple theft charges on record.

JESSICA
No! That's not me! It's not me! What do you even gain from framing me like this?

ASHLEY
Whether it's a lie or not, my own conscience is clear.

**Episode 58**

101 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 101

JESSICA
That's truly not me!

ASHLEY
I told you, stolen things always have to be returned.

SELENA
Even if her past is disgraceful, what does it have to do with Miss Vale's current status?

RUBY
Exactly! It only further proves that the Chairman of AO Group should be a role model for all of us.

NOAH
That's right. Miss Vale relied solely on her own strength to become the Chairman of the global conglomerate AO Group. All that does is demonstrate her capabilities and unparalleled intelligence.

SELENA
Miss Vale was destined to be someone people like you could never hope to measure up to in a lifetime.

ASHLEY
When a dream is shattered, it really is hard to accept, isn't it? But let's see if you can keep denying the truth after this next video. Play it.

A video begins to play on the huge screen.

102 INT. RESTAURANT - DAY 102

In a dimly lit corner of the restaurant, Jessica is seen clinging to Vincent's neck.

JESSICA
Darling, I'm already pregnant. When are you finally going to divorce that old hag?

**Episode 59**

103 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY 103

Selena, Ruby, and Beatrice stare in shock.

ASHLEY
So, "fake president," can you keep up the act now?

Jessica panics, flustered.

JESSICA
I… I only pretended to be the president because I had no other choice!

Selena sways unsteadily on her feet.

SELENA
What? I can't believe I mistook a mistress for the President of AO Group!

Ruby slaps Jessica hard across the face.

RUBY
I treated you as my best friend, and you were trying to seduce my dad?!

JESSICA
Ruby, let me expl—

RUBY
Shut the fuck up!

Before Jessica can finish, Beatrice slaps her on the other side of her face.

BEATRICE
The evidence is right there, and you're still making excuses for yourself?!

Noah, seething, slaps Jessica hard as well.

NOAH
What the fuck, you bitch?! You've deceived us all!

Selena snaps out of her daze. She asks Ruby:

SELENA
Where's your dad?

RUBY
He said he was going to the restroom.
(Ruby suddenly spots Vincent.)
There he is!

Vincent's at the edge of the crowd, trying to slip away unnoticed. The crowd parts automatically. Vincent has no choice but to walk towards Jessica and slap her across the face.

VINCENT
You whore! How dare you seduce me?!

Jessica, thoroughly beaten, collapses onto the ground.

JESSICA
What right do you have to hit me? Everyone else can blame me, but not you! You're the father of my child!

Vincent slams his foot into Jessica's stomach.

VINCENT
To hell with you! That bastard's not mine! Don't you dare pin it on me!

**Episode 60**

104 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 104

JESSICA
If you hadn't raped me, how would I have ended up like this?

Selena freezes in shock as Vincent grabs her shoulder, frantically trying to explain.

VINCENT
Darling, don't listen to her nonsense! She only wanted my money and threw herself at me. You're the only one I love.

Selena shoves Vincent's hand away, her face filled with fury.

SELENA
Your so-called love is absolutely disgusting.

VINCENT
I made the same mistake any man might make. Can't you forgive me just this once?

SELENA
You got her pregnant, and you still expect me to forgive you?!

VINCENT
That child can't be mine!
(to Jessica)
Could it be David's?

JESSICA
What did you just say? You were the one who told me to seduce David in the first place, and now you're pinning it all on me?!

NOAH
What? That dirty old man David vouched for you as president because you were sleeping with him?

Ashley smirks coldly from the side.

ASHLEY
Looks like the case is closed.

NOAH
So… my promotion was all a lie? I've really been fired?

Noah despairs.

VINCENT
Selena, you see for yourself. She's just a promiscuous little bitch! Trust me!

SELENA
And how exactly am I supposed to trust you?

VINCENT
You know the truth—wherever the money is, that's where the heart is. My heart has always been with you. What more could you possibly want?

Selena suppresses her rage as Vincent lowers his voice, pleading.

VINCENT (CONT'D)
Darling, there are so many people watching. Please, save me some face. Just help me one last time.

SELENA
Remember, this is the last time.

Selena turns sharply and slaps Jessica, who's just managed to sit up.

SELENA (CONT'D)
You bitch! How dare you slander my husband!

**Episode 61**

105 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 105

Ruby steps forward and slaps Jessica from the other side.

RUBY
Liar! How dare you talk about my dad like that!

Beatrice follows up with another slap to the opposite side of Jessica's face.

BEATRICE
Exactly! How dare you try to pin this on Vincent!

JESSICA
What right do you all have to hit me?!

Jessica clutches her face, disheveled and humiliated. Ashley shakes her head, a cold smirk on her face.

ASHLEY
What a loving family you all are. Truly, I admire your acting skills. Even knowing Jessica is a victim, you shamelessly enable this monster and have become accomplices to a complete rapist.

SELENA
Shut your mouth, bitch!

ASHLEY
Looks like you won't cry until your back's to the wall. Fine, let's bring out the evidence.

Zoe hands Ashley a folder. Ashley raises it high.

ASHLEY (CONT'D)
In here is evidence and testimony proving that Vincent, over the years, has used his position as a restaurant owner to assault 23 young women. I originally planned to deal with this after the contract signing, but it seems like now is the perfect time.

Selena freezes, shocked.

**Episode 62**

106 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 106

VINCENT
(panicking)
Don't listen to her nonsense! That evidence is all fake!

SELENA
(to Ashley)
If you keep spewing lies, I'll tear your mouth apart!

ASHLEY
Are you still this delusion? It's your repeated indulgence that's caused so many girls to suffer.

SELENA
Shut the fuck up!

VINCENT
(furious)
You think some baseless so-called evidence can scare me? If you push me any further, you and your floor-scrubbing mother will suffer!

ASHLEY
Save those words for the police.

Ashley catches Zoe's eye. Zoe nods. Two police officers enter the hall, flashing their badges.

POLICE OFFICER 1
Vincent Hart, you're being detained on suspicion of rape and illegal business operations.

The officers grab Vincent.

POLICE OFFICER 2
Miss Winters, thank you for providing all the evidence.

POLICE OFFICER 1
Not only have you successfully managed a massive conglomerate like AO Group, but you're also a committed citizen dedicated to fighting crime. Truly admirable.

ASHLEY
You're too kind. It's my absolute pleasure to serve justice.

SELENA
So… Ashley is really the President of AO Group?

The crowd murmurs.

POLICE OFFICER 1
(to Ashley)
If you need further assistance, please don't hesitate to ask.

ASHLEY
I’m extremely grateful. As for family matters, don’t worry yourselves.

**Episode 63**

107 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 107

BEATRICE
So, my very own granddaughter is actually the chairwoman of AO Group? What have I been doing all this time?

NOAH
What? She's really the president?

SELENA
Ashley, you're the bigger person. For the sake of him being your uncle-in-law, please spare him.

ASHLEY
You’ve only started pleading for him now? Don’t you think it’s a little too late?

SELENA
It’s not too late, definitely not too late. As long as you withdraw the lawsuit now, we still have time to resolve everything.

ASHLEY
Dream on! Let someone like him roam free, just so he can set eyes on another victim?

VINCENT
No, no! I’ve learned my lesson. Ashley, please, give me another chance!

Vincent, with tears and snot running down his cheeks, begs.

ASHLEY
A chance? When those girls begged you bitterly for mercy, did you give them a chance?

VINCENT
(forcing a smile)
My dear niece, I'll give you all my money. I'll give you everything! If that's not enough to quench your anger, you can hit me stupid, too.

Vincent tries to move closer, but two police officers on either side of him hold him firmly. Ashley steps forward and slaps him hard across the face.

ASHLEY
You deserve this slap! It's for disregarding the law and committing such heinous acts!

The police press Vincent down as he struggles.

OFFICER 1
Behave yourself!

ASHLEY
(Ashley slaps Vincent again.)
This slap is for the 23 girls whose lives you destroyed!
(Ashley slaps Vincent a third time.)
And this slap is for the me from ten years ago! Take him away!

VINCENT
(fiercely)
Hold on. I'll tell you this: all I have to do is spend some money and I'll be free. And when I'm out, I won't let you off!

**Episode 64**

108 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 108

ASHLEY
Oh? If I didn't have enough strength today, wouldn't I have ended up just like those girls: suffering in silence, terrified because of your threats.

VINCENT
You're not afraid, huh? But is your floor-scrubbing mom not afraid either? Once I'm out, I'll make sure to kill both of you.

Vincent glares furiously at Ashley.

ASHLEY
Don't worry. Your crimes are enough to keep you locked up for life. Take him away!

Vincent, speechless, is dragged away by the policemen. Suddenly, Jessica stands up and blocks the officers.

JESSICA
No! He can't go.

ASHLEY
You're still pleading for the man who raped you and forced you to be his mistress for ten years?

JESSICA
What do you know? He's still the father of my child. My life is already ruined, but how I can I let my child grow up without a father?!

ASHLEY
Don't you realize it was your endless tolerance that dragged you so deep into this abyss?

JESSICA
You'll never understand what it means to be born into a slum full of addicts. Do you know what any of that means?!

ASHLEY
You can't choose where you're born, but you can choose how you see it, can decide your own path. You can't blame your origins for your failures and shortcomings.

JESSICA
I'm trying to change my destiny! I want a better life, too. What have I done wrong?

109 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 109

ASHLEY
Do you want me to tell you where you went wrong? Wanting to work hard, to realize your value, there's nothing wrong with that. But your mistake lies in resorting to deceit and shady shortcuts. Your mistake lies in your dream of relying on men in order to lead a good life.

JESSICA
Aren't men every woman's destiny? A woman's life is just about finding a good home. I'm just like most women, looking for a rich man to depend on.

ASHLEY
Women are independent individuals. They don't exist to cling to men. If you want a good life, you should depend on the work of your own two hands.

JESSICA
Plenty of people have a good life because they were born into good families or married rich husbands. I was born at the bottom of society. I'm not fated to find a good man. This life, I accept.

ASHLEY
Fate isn't something to accept, it's something to change. It's your refusal to stand on your own two feet. Instead, you becoming his secret lover merely led to more women being assaulted.

JESSICA
It wasn't like that. Shut up!

ASHLEY
You could have stood up and fought back, but instead, you coveted money, endured being his mistress, and became his accomplice.

JESSICA (EMOTIONAL)
I was only 18 at the time. I was too young, and I was really scared.

ASHLEY
Now I'm giving you a chance to make a new choice. Will you testify against him?

**Episode 66**

110 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 110

JESSICA
I... but he's still the father of my child.

ASHLEY
A father who wants to kill your child?

JESSICA
No, no! He's my man. He loves me.

Ashley shakes her head. Selena slaps Jessica across the face.

SELENA
You shameless slut! Shut the fuck up! He's my man. It's not your place to plead for him.

Jessica slaps Selena in return.

JESSICA
He stopped loving you a long time ago, you stupid swine.

Selena retaliates with another slap.

SELENA
I'm his wife. He loves me!

Jessica slaps Selena.

JESSICA
(growing deranged)
Let me tell you something, I'm the chairwoman of AO Group, a global conglomerate! Hahaha! You fucking dare disrespect me? You'll regret this!

ASHLEY
(shaking her head)
How pathetic.
(to the police)
Take him away.

The officers drag Vincent away.

JESSICA
(manically)
No! No one's allowed to take him away! I'm the president of AO Group! Even the president's orders you're willing to ignore?

ASHLEY
Look, she really has lost her mind. Take her to a psychiatric hospital.

Two bodyguards seize Jessica, who struggles furiously against them.

**Episode 67**

111 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 111

JESSICA
Let me go! I'm not going! Ruby, help me!

Jessica desperately calls to Ruby, but Ruby shoves her away.

RUBY
You piece of shit, get out of my sight!

JESSICA
You're telling me to leave? Pretending to be the chairwoman was all your idea!

Noah and Selena's expressions are stunned.

RUBY
You crazy son of a bitch, don't you dare slander me!

JESSICA
Wasn't it you who promised me? You said that if I pretended to be the AO Group's chairwoman, you'd marry Noah, take his shares, and use the money to clear all my debts?!

Noah looks at Ruby.

NOAH
Is that true? You married me only because of my shares?

RUBY
Darling, don't listen to her nonsense!

Noah slaps Ruby across the face.

RUBY (CONT'D)
You hit me?! You said you'd love me for the rest of your life?!

NOAH
I hit you because you deserve it. If your family weren't rich, and if you didn't throw yourself at me-- though your skills in bed aren't bad--who would be with you? Who would ever love you?

RUBY
(stunned)
What?! You motherfucker!

Ruby reaches out to slap Noah, but he shoves her to the ground. Noah then kneels, grabbing the hem of Ashley's dress, begging.

NOAH
Ashley, it was all this whore's manipulation! Don't worry, I'll cut her off completely, and we can get back together, okay? I really do love you!

Ashley, disgusted, pulls her skirt free.

ASHLEY
Your "love" is revolting. Get away from me. I never want to see you again.

Noah collapses in despair. Ruby slaps Jessica. Jessica hits her stomach against the corner of a table and falls.

RUBY
You goddamn insane woman! It's all your fault! If it weren't for you, Noah would have never left me!

**Episode 68**

112 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 112

Jessica lies on the floor, blood dripping from her thigh. She touches the blood and begins to scream.

JESSICA
Ah! My baby, my baby!

ASHLEY
She's all yours now.

Ashley signals to Zoe. Zoe orders people to carry Jessica away and gestures for the police to take Vincent into custody.

Ruby and Selena rush toward Vincent.

RUBY
Dad!

SELENA
Vincent!

Bodyguards block Ruby and Selena. Beatrice anxiously slams her cane on the floor.

BEATRICE
Our perfect family! Why must you tear it apart to be satisfied?

ASHLEY
I'm truly sorry that the harmonious, respectable façade of your wealthy family has come crashing down.

Selena grabs a knife and charges at Ashley.

SELENA
You goddamn fucking bitch! You ruined my family, ruined everything I had! I'll make you pay!

Jack shoves Selena to the ground. Ruby rushes to help Selena up.

RUBY
Mom!

Ruby picks up the knife and charges at Ashley.

RUBY (CONT'D)
Why? Why do I lose everything while you get to stay on top as chairwoman?

Jack steps forward and knocks the knife out of Ruby's hand.

ORION
Take them all to the police station.

BEATRICE
Wait! We're family! Blood is thicker than water! She's your own little sister. How can you send your her to the police? Ruby, apologize to your big sister now!

RUBY
Apologize to her? She doesn't deserve it!

**Episode 69**

113 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 113

BEATRICE
Ruby, what bullshit are you spouting? Ashley, don't take it to heart.

RUBY
I'll fucking tell you! I hated your self-righteous, fake demeanor from the very start. You've always been jealous that my family was better than yours, that they had more money, with parents who loved me.

ASHLEY
Dirty heart always sees the world as dirty too. I was willing to let this go out of respect for our family ties, but clearly, that's unnecessary now. Take them away.

BEATRICE
No, no, no! Marina, say something to Ashley. After all, we're family!

MARINA
Ashley, can we let this go?

ASHLEY
Mom, all my life, you've taught me to be tolerant, to forgive others. But our tolerance has only encouraged their exploitation. Step-by-step violating us. Mom, as long as I'm here, we won't back down anymore.

Beatrice slaps Ruby across the face.

BEATRICE
Apologize to Ashley! Or do you really want to end up in jail?

**Episode 70**

114 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 114

RUBY
(reluctantly)
Ashley, I'm sorry. I was wrong.

SELENA
Yes, we were wrong.

BEATRICE
Ashley, they've admitted their mistakes sincerely. Please forgive them.

ASHLEY
Repenting sincerely? I think they've just realized they're powerless to fight back. If I weren't the chairwoman today, just an ordinary person, you'd have tormented us to death.

BEATRICE
How could that be?

ASHLEY
How? A group of bullies who prey on the weak. If you didn't want this ending, why start it in the first place? Take them away!

Ruby panics.

RUBY
No, no, no! Cousin, I don't want to go to prison. I was wrong!

SELENA
Yes, we were wrong! Ashley, my dear niece—-no, no, Chairwoman. Forgive us!

ASHLEY
Admitting your mistakes now? Don’t you think it’s too late?

RUBY
It’s not too late, it’s not too late! I’m still young, I really can’t go to prison. Cousin, I was wrong! I was wrong from the start. I shouldn’t have stolen your boyfriend, shouldn’t have been jealous of you for being better at school, and shouldn’t have helped my father frame you.

ASHLEY
Do you know the biggest difference between you and me? The biggest difference is that I’ve never seen you as an enemy. I’ve always considered you family, someone connected by blood. I’ve sincerely hoped you could live a good life, but you’ve always treated me as a thorn in your side.

SELENA
I’m so sorry. Please forgive your aunt. I shouldn’t have framed you, and I certainly shouldn’t have humiliated you.

**Episode 71**

115 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 115

ASHLEY
You shouldn’t be begging me; you should be begging my mother.

Ashley glares at Selena and Ruby, her eyes filled with anger.

SELENA
Marina, I was wrong. I shouldn't have taken your money, and I definitely shouldn't have bullied you just because you were a cleaner. Please, help me beg for forgiveness.

MARINA
Ashley, they seem genuinely remorseful. Why don't we just let this go.

BEATRICE
Yes, Ashley. My darling granddaughter, look how accomplished you are now. Don't hold grudges against your little sister and your aunt.

ASHLEY
Grandma, you seem to have forgotten your own words. If I didn't have money today, you'd probably never even acknowledge me as your granddaughter.

BEATRICE
What are you saying, Ashley? Look at you—so successful. Grandma is proud of you. Of course, you're my dear granddaughter.

ASHLEY
I used to long for this family bond. I thought that when I became capable, I could repay you all. But your shallow greed, your fawning over power, and your disregard for anything else—you've destroyed this wealth and this family connection with your own hands.

BEATRICE
It's Grandma's fault. Please, forgive me.

ASHLEY
I'm no saint, I can't fully forgive you. I won't pursue legal charges against you, but from now on, I don't want to see any of you again.

ORION
Get the fuck out right now!

Ruby and Selena support Beatrice as they leave.

BEATRICE
My Lord, I was the one who destroyed this unimaginable wealth with my own hands. I've ruined this family bond myself!

**Episode 72**

116 INT. PROMOTIONAL BANQUET HALL - DAY - CONTINUOUS 116

Ashley takes Marina's hand.

ASHLEY
Mom, let me formally introduce you. This is my fiancé, Orion Vale.

ORION
It's a pleasure to meet you, Mrs. Winters.

MARINA (BEAMING)
Wonderful, wonderful! Handsome and considerate, as well as marrying my daughter. You put my heart at ease. When are you two getting married?

ASHLEY
It'll be next month. Orion Vale, will you be my love for the rest of our lives?

Orion, moved, smiles with tears in his eyes.

ORION
A proposal should never come from the lady.

He pulls out an enormous pink ring, and drops to one knee to propose.

ORION (CONT'D)
Ashley, will you be my partner for life, and let me love you for all of it?

ASHLEY
(eyes full of tears)
I will.

Ashley and Orion embrace sweetly.

**THE END**